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No Half Truths

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TRADERS, ENTREPRENEURS: GROWTH DRIVERS, SAYS CM P3

RED FORT CELEBRATIONS TO SEE MAIDEN RENDITION OF 'VANDE MATARAM' P5

CELEBRATING GLORIOUS 150 YEARS OF 'VANDE MATARAM' P14

Caste enters Census 2027 as Centre notifies 40 questions

New questions seek Aadhaar, Voter ID, bank accounts and Covid vaccination details

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

India's Census 2027 will for the first time since Independence collect caste details as part of the population count, with census officials instructed to record the caste exactly as stated by respondents rather than choose from a pre-set list. The Registrar General of India (RGI) on Friday notified 40 questions for the population enumeration, the second phase of the decennial exercise, which will begin early in snow-bound regions from September 1 and cover the rest of the country in February 2027.

Caste is listed as question 10 in the household schedule along with a query on whether a person belongs to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe. The questionnaire is not expected to contain a list of castes, allowing respondents to provide their caste in their own words. The approach differs from caste surveys conducted in Bihar and Telangana, where respondents selected their caste from state-specific lists. It is similar to the method used in the 2011 Socio-Economic Caste Census.

Self-enumeration for the population count in Ladakh and snow-bound areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand will be available from August 17 to 31, followed by door-to-door enumeration from September 1 to 30. The government has scheduled the exercise earlier in these areas because of winter conditions. Population enumeration across the rest of India will take place in February 2027.

The 40-question schedule covers personal, social, educational, employment and migration details. Respondents will be asked about their name, sex, age, marital status, age at marriage, spouse, nationality, religion, mother tongue, other languages known, disability, literacy and digital literacy. Questions will also cover school attendance, highest educational qualification, field of study and employment during the previous year, including occupation, industry, trade or service, worker category and availability CONTINUED ON P4

FILE PHOTO/ANI

KEY POINT

- Caste is question 10 on the household schedule
- Caste will be recorded as respondents declare it
- No pre-set caste list will be provided
- Census adds 11 questions over 2011.
- Mobile, Aadhaar and Voter ID details will be collected
- Passport and driving licence details will also be sought
- Covid vaccination place and bank accounts will be recorded
- Questions cover education, work, migration and disability
- Women will report children and recent births

CJI slams BCI's move against NALSAR students

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 14

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Friday questioned the Bar Council of India's decision to temporarily block the enrolment of 2026 graduates of NALSAR University of Law after some students objected to his proposed participation as chief guest at the Hyderabad institute's convocation.

SAYS THEY HAVE RIGHT TO PROTEST

Calling the matter "a dialogue between students and me", Kant said the BCI had no role in interfering with students' right to protest. A bench headed by him, comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, said even if the students were wrong, they had the right to protest peacefully.

The court directed NALSAR to advise its students to complete their enrolment as advocates at the earliest and CONTINUED ON P4

Students are architects of India's future, says President amid protests

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

Underlining that students are the "architects of India's future," President Droupadi Murmu on Friday said the government is taking comprehensive steps to reform public examinations to completely curb paper leaks and unfair means, making the system transparent, secure, and trustworthy.

In her address to the nation on the eve of the country's 80th Independence Day, she stressed that just as government and society remain united to ensure national security, everyone must contribute through joint and concerted efforts to safeguard the present and future of students.

"Public examinations become gateways to opportunities for our students. The government is undertaking comprehensive steps to reform these examinations. The objectives of these reforms are to completely curb the use of unfair means in public examinations, make the examination system more transparent, more secure, and more trustworthy for the youth," President Murmu said.

Her remarks assume significance in the backdrop of CONTINUED ON P4

HIGHLIGHTS

- Murmu urged collective efforts to safeguard students' present and future
- She praised the "unmatched valour" of the Indian Armed Forces
- Murmu described eliminating Naxalism as a major national achievement

Millenniumpost

WE WISH OUR READERS A HAPPY **Independence Day**

THERE WILL BE NO EDITION ON AUG 16, 2026

'Share deep, strong ties with Italy, show respect': MEA on political jibe at Meloni

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

India on Friday emphasised that it shares a strong relationship with Italy and underscored the importance of maintaining mutual respect in public discourse, a day after a Congress leader triggered a controversy with his political jibe at Italian Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni.

External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal emphasised this at his bi-weekly media briefing while responding to a question on Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's criticism of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's handling of foreign policy and subsequent remarks by Congress leader and former MP Sandeep Dikshit.

"We have strong ties with Italy. Our ties with Italy in recent years have expanded and strengthened. It is important that as part of diplomatic practice, we strengthen our ties keeping in mind being respectful of each other," Jaiswal said.

In an address at a Congress party event on Thursday evening, Gandhi scoffed at Modi's handling of CONTINUED ON P4

NCB brings fugitive drug kingpin Virender back from UAE

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 14

The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) on Friday brought fugitive drug trafficker Virender Singh Basoya back to India from the United Arab Emirates (UAE), where he was arrested in June following an Interpol Red Notice, in a major breakthrough in a probe into a drug syndicate linked to the recovery of around 1,837 kg of Mephedrone from Pune and Delhi. Basoya, a resident of Delhi's Sarojini Nagar, was arrested on arrival at Indira Gandhi International Airport.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said the development was part of the government's efforts to pursue drug traffickers operating from abroad. "No matter where drug traffickers hide, they cannot escape the long arm of Indian law," Shah said in a post on X, describing the action as a new milestone in the policy of zero tolerance CONTINUED ON P4

US accuses over 40 nations of helping China evade tariffs

MPOST BUREAU
Washington, August 14

The US has accused more than 40 countries, including India, of being part of a "shadow trans-shipment network" that helps China bypass high American tariffs, and announced plans to use artificial intelligence to detect and penalise such trade practices.

In a report titled The Great Transshipment Scam, Peter Navarro, US Counsellor to the President for Trade and Manufacturing, said the practice became more widespread after the Trump administration imposed Section 301 tariffs on Chinese goods in 2018 to counter what it described as unfair trade practices. CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

SC quashes defamation case against Rahul

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday quashed a criminal defamation complaint and summons issued against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi over his remarks about Hindutva ideologue Vinayak Damodar Savarkar, citing the absence of mandatory government sanction.

A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu allowed Gandhi's plea, noting that sanction required under Section 196 of CONTINUED ON P4

Govt to scrap 12-min/hour ad cap for TV

New Delhi: The government has decided to remove the 12-minute-per-hour limit on advertisements carried by television channels, the Information and Broadcasting Ministry said on Friday, citing major changes in the broadcasting sector and the need to ensure fair competition with digital media.

The existing restriction under CONTINUED ON P4

TOLL RISES TO SEVEN

Rescue teams race to save 3 trapped workers in U'khand's Chamoli tunnel

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 14

Specialist rescue teams on Friday continued a race against time to locate three workers missing inside an under-construction tunnel at the Vishnugad-Pipalkoti hydroelectric project in Uttarakhand's Chamoli district, a day after a sudden rush of water and debris killed seven people.

The incident took place around 7 pm on Thursday at the Tehri Hydro Development Corporation (THDC) project in Mayapur, near Pipalkoti. Landslides and subsidence caused debris and water to enter the three-kilometre tunnel, filling nearly half of it CONTINUED ON P4

Girl heading to I-Day event killed after bus runs over scooter; 1 hurt

Bus allegedly in wrong lane; stone-pelting erupts

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

A class 8 student's trip to attend Independence Day celebrations at her school turned fatal when a DTC electric bus, allegedly driving in the wrong lane, hit the scooter she was riding with her uncle in the New Ashok Nagar area on Friday, police said.

Following the incident, angry locals pelted stones at the bus, damaging its front windshield and windows.

Police said they controlled the situation from escalating and arrested the bus driver, who had fled after the accident.

The girl, identified as a 12-year-old Kayna Pal, was on her way to school for an Independence Day programme when the accident took place around 8 am on Dallupura Road.

According to police, she was travelling on a scooter with her uncle when the DTC bus hit them, causing her to fall and suffer fatal injuries.

Her inconsolable father, Aman Pal, was seen waiting outside the mortuary as the body was taken for a postmortem.

He said, "My younger brother was taking her to school for the programme when the bus came from the wrong side and struck their scooter.

"The impact threw the child onto the road, following which her head came under the wheels of the bus."

Police said the girl died on the spot and they shifted the body to Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital for medico-legal proceedings.

The deceased's other uncle, Virender Singh, said the girl died on the spot, and her uncle received injuries, but he is out of danger and was fit to give his statement to police.

Her grandfather, Dharam Singh, said the girl had left home for the school's August 15 programme.

He described her as a bright student and said the family was now waiting for the postmortem process to be completed before taking her body home.

"The journey to school turned into an unimaginable tragedy. Kayna had left home expecting to attend an Independence Day programme, but within minutes, her family was rushing to the accident site and hospital," said a resident.

Eyewitnesses and residents alleged that the driver fled the spot after the collision while several passengers were still inside the bus.

The accident left residents enraged, with some throwing stones at the bus.

Police said they are also probing the stone-pelting incident.

They said the DTC bus driver, identified as 45-year-old S K Murad, initially fled the scene out of fear but was subsequently apprehended.

A police officer said an investigation was underway to ascertain the circumstances that led to the fatal collision.

SHATTERED MORNING

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- She was travelling on a scooter with her uncle when the bus hit them, causing her to fall and suffer fatal injuries
- Her inconsolable father, Aman Pal, was seen waiting outside the mortuary as the body was taken for a postmortem

Noida teenager kills father & jumps before Metro train

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Noida, August 14

A 16-year-old boy allegedly killed his father and later died by suicide by jumping in front of a metro train at Sector 52 station here, police said on Friday.

The incident occurred on Wednesday, when the teenager allegedly killed his father, Raju Sharma, a tutor, and subsequently went to the metro station, they said.

According to preliminary investigation, the teenager had been living with his father in the rented accommodation in Garhi Chaukhandi village for about three months and was depressed over his father's alleged harsh behaviour and his mother's absence.

Police said the boy's mother had left Raju after the COVID-19 pandemic and was living separately.

"Early Wednesday morning, while his father was asleep, he killed Raju. Afterward, he went to the Sector-52 Metro station, where he attempted to take his own life by jumping in front of a train," police said.

The Sector 49 police station received information through Dial-112 that a boy had jumped before a train at the Metro station. Metro staff and security personnel rushed him to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared him dead.

The deceased later identified as the 16-year-old boy, son of Raju Sharma and a resident of Sector 73 in Noida. After completion of the inquest proceedings, his body was sent for postmortem and later handed over to his mother and maternal uncle, police said.

The discovery of Raju's body came later. Arun, Raju's brother, approached police outposts at Parthala and Garhi Chaukhandi seeking help in locating his brother's rented accommodation.

Police recovered Raju's body from a rented room near Tikona Park after reports of a foul smell. Further investigation is underway.

> **HE WAS DEPRESSED OVER HIS FATHER'S ALLEGED HARSH BEHAVIOUR AND HIS MOTHER'S ABSENCE**

PAINTED PRIDE

A girl shows her face painted in the colours of the national flag, in New Delhi, on Friday PTI

Child killer nabbed 2 yrs after parole jump

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

A man serving a life sentence for kidnapping and killing a 14-month-old child was arrested by the Delhi Police nearly two years after he jumped parole, police said on Friday.

Kalim Seikh was granted 45 days parole by the Delhi High Court in October 2024 but failed to surrender before the jail authorities after its expiry and remained absconding, they said.

The accused was arrested from Gandhi Nagar on August 12 following a tip-off, a senior police officer said.

The case was registered at Khajuri Khas police station in January 2013 after the child went missing from his residence in Shri Ram Colony. During the investigation, the child's body was recovered and sections pertaining to murder and kidnapping were added to the FIR, police said.

Seikh was sentenced to life imprisonment in 2017 after being convicted in the child murder case.

DECLARED HOAX

HC & IGI Airport T-3 receive bomb threats

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

The Delhi High Court, Terminal 3 of Delhi airport and several other government offices in the national capital on Friday received bomb threats via email ahead of Independence Day, officials said. Police declared all threats to be a hoax after carrying out searches and security checks.

A police source said that Delhi Cantonment SDM Office received an email at 11:18 am, Terminal 3 of the Indira Gandhi International Airport (IGI) Airport at 11:32 am, Jamnagar House at 11:40 am, Saket SDM Office at 11:42 am and Jhandewalan at 11:57 am received bomb threat calls at the Fire Control Room.

Teams of the Delhi Police, bomb squad and fire brigade rushed to all five locations and all calls were declared hoaxes.

A bomb disposal squad and sniffer dogs searched the Delhi High Court after a bomb threat email, while security was tightened. Nothing suspicious was found.

Red Fort gets multi-layered security

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

Security arrangements at the Red Fort have been strengthened with a multi-layered anti-terror response plan, over 1,000 CCTV cameras with AI-based video analytics ahead of the Independence Day celebrations, a senior police officer said on Friday.

Security agencies have also carried out mock drills and advance liaison with various stakeholders to ensure better coordination during the celebrations.

"Elaborate security arrangements have been put in place in view of incidents reported in the national capital last year, with a focus on ensuring that people attending the celebrations face minimum inconvenience," Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) Raja Banthia said.

"We have elaborate security arrangements this time, keeping in mind the incidents witnessed in the national capital last year," Banthia said.

The security plan includes multiple layers of checking and screening at and around the Red Fort, along with an anti-terror response plan to deal with any possible threat or emergency situation, the officer said.

"Advance liaison, mock drills and advance intimation have been carried out so that all agencies are prepared and there is a coordinated response in case of any emergency," the DCP said.

More than 1,000 CCTV cameras have been deployed inside and outside the Red Fort to keep a close watch on the area, he said.

The cameras are linked with systems equipped with AI-based video analytics, while live feeds are being monitored from a dedicated control room, the DCP said.

The surveillance system will enable security personnel to detect suspicious activity, crowd-related issues or any other law and order situation and respond immediately, he said. Response teams will be deployed at strategic locations, while traffic and visitor movement near the Red Fort will be regulated. Security has been intensified across Delhi, with heightened surveillance and specialised teams deployed ahead of Independence Day.

PRESIDENT'S MEDAL FOR DISTINGUISHED SERVICE (PSM)

SH. DINESH KUMAR GUPTA, IPS, ADDL. CP

SI (EXE.) RAJESH KUMAR

MEDAL FOR MERITORIOUS SERVICE (MSM)

SH. SURENDER KUMAR, IPS, JT. CP
MS NUPUR PRASAD, IPS, JT. CP
INSPR. (EXE.) RAKESH KUMAR BHATT
INSP. (STENO) TARA DUTT
ASI (EXE.) KAILASH CHAND
W/SI (EXE.) ANJANA KUMARI
ASI (EXE.) SATISH PATIL
ASI (EXE.) ANAND BALLABH
ASI (EXE.) PRADEEP KUMAR SHARMA
W/ASI (EXE.) BINDU
W/ASI (EXE.) DINESH KUMARI
W/HC (EXE.) LALITA
W/HC (EXE.) SHARMILA
W/HC (EXE.) PUSHA RANI
HC (EXE.) VIJAY SINGH

Three shooters linked to Tillu gang in cop net

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

The Delhi Police's Special Cell has arrested three alleged shooters linked to the Tillu Tajpuriya-Kaushal Chaudhary-Gurvinder Baba gang, police said.

The accused were identified as Hemant alias Monu, 33, Nayan Aggarwal, 25, and Durgesh Rai alias Devil, 22. Police recovered two semi-automatic pistols and live ammunition from them.

Hemant and Nayan were arrested on August 2 after being tracked for over 10 days. Police said they had allegedly procured weapons from Zirakpur in May on Gurvinder's instructions and were planning to fire at two salons in Chandigarh to extort money. Durgesh was arrested on August 8 for allegedly firing at a house in Karnal, Haryana, at Gurvinder's direction. No one was injured.

Police said further investigation is underway to identify other gang members.

Police bust Indo-Nepal charas network

106 kg charas worth Rs 109 crore seized; four Nepalese arrested

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 14

The Delhi Police has busted an alleged Indo-Nepal narcotics-trafficking network and arrested four Nepalese nationals, recovering 106.250 kg of high-quality charas worth around Rs 109 crore, police said.

The Special Staff launched the operation following an intelligence input about a network allegedly involved in procuring, transporting, storing and selling charas across Delhi-NCR.

The latest action followed a raid on August 12 at a suspected storage facility in Wazirabad, where police recovered 97.652 kg of charas packed in 13 plastic packets, along with a mixing machine and packing material. Police arrested 32-year-old Roshni Magar, who allegedly facilitated the large-scale storage of charas in Delhi.

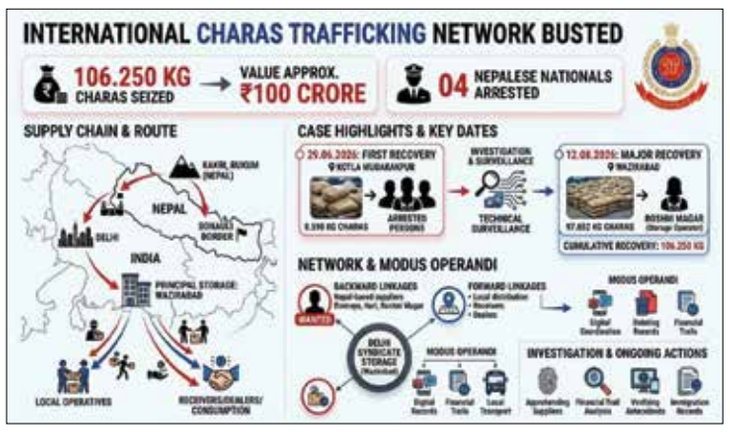
According to police, Magar had returned to Nepal after three other accused were arrested, but came back to Delhi recently, believing that the investigation had not focused on her.

The anti-drug squad had earlier arrested Bharat Thapa, 32, Govind Budha, 32, and Jyoti Pun Magar, 50, on June 29 following intelligence inputs about Nepalese nationals allegedly involved in smuggling charas into Delhi. Police recovered 8.598 kg of charas from them and registered an FIR under Sections 20, 25 and 29 of the NDPS Act at Kotla Mubarakpur police station.

Questioning and technical surveillance subsequently led investigators to Roshni and helped uncover the wider supply chain. Police also identified two Nepalese nationals, Binmaya and Hari, whose alleged roles are being investigated.

Police said the accused sourced charas through a Nepal-based network operating across the Indo-Nepal Sonauli border. The consignments were allegedly transported to Delhi by road to evade detection. Deals were arranged through social media, with payments made in cash and through electronic transfers.

Deliveries were allegedly made using autorickshaws and bike taxis, with Wazirabad and Majnu ka Tila emerging as key local demand centres.



SMUGGLING TRAIL

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- 8.598 kg of charas recovered from them; FIR under Sections 20, 25 and 29 of NDPS

Shah warns drug traffickers

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said the government was tracking drug traffickers hiding abroad and dismantling their networks. He cited the Narcotics Control Bureau's securing of fugitive drug kingpin Virender Singh Basoya's return from the UAE as another milestone in the government's zero-tolerance approach to narcotics.

Further investigation is underway to trace Nepal-based suppliers, follow the financial trail and identify local distributors.

China-linked scam network busted

4 held over Rs 12L Telegram scam

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 14

The Delhi Police's Cyber Cell has busted a China-based cyber fraud network allegedly involved in supplying mule bank accounts to foreign fraudsters running work-from-home, task-based scams.

Four people, including an account supplier, operator, agent and account holder, have been arrested from Haryana and Uttar Pradesh, police said.

The case came to light after a Delhi resident reported losing Rs 12 lakh in a Telegram-based work-from-home scam. The victim was initially promised payment for completing tasks but was later made to pay money as security and processing charges for withdrawing the purported earnings.

During the investigation, police found that the Telegram IDs used by the fraudsters were linked to IP addresses in China. Tracking the money trail led investigators to a bank account belonging to Gagan Yadav, which had allegedly been provided to the China-based fraudsters.

Police arrested Geetam Singh, who allegedly supplied mule accounts to the foreign fraudsters and converted the proceeds of crime into USDT, a cryptocurrency. His interrogation led to the arrest of Dhruv, who allegedly facilitated the opening of bank accounts. Anuj Sharma and account holder Gagan Yadav were subsequently arrested.

Police recovered nine bank passbooks, five SIM cards, six mobile phones and a register containing details of commissions paid for the accounts.

Further investigation is underway to identify other members of the network.

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Traders, entrepreneurs: Growth drivers, says CM

At Bharatiya Vyapar Mahotsav, CM backs business community

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 14 August

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday said traders, entrepreneurs, MSMEs and startups are playing a key role in strengthening India's economy as she addressed the Bharatiya Vyapar Mahotsav 2026 at Bharat Mandapam. Organised by the Confederation of All India Traders (CAIT) in association with the India Trade Promotion Organisation (ITPO), the event showcased India's trade potential, entrepreneurship, innovation and manufacturing capabilities. MP and CAIT Secretary General Praveen Khandelwal, CAIT National President B.C. Bhartia and other dignitaries attended the programme.

Addressing the gathering,

> THE COUNTRY HAD MOVED BEYOND THE CONCEPT OF VOCAL FOR LOCAL TO LOCAL TO GLOBAL

Gupta said the country had moved beyond the concept of "Vocal for Local" to "Local to Global", with Indian-made products gaining recognition in international markets.

"Trade and entrepreneurship have emerged as strong pillars of India's economic strength under the vision of Viksit Bharat. Traders, MSMEs, startups and manufacturers are driving this transformation and taking Indian products to global markets," she said. The Chief Minister described Delhi as one of India's leading commercial hubs, highlighting markets such as Chandni Chowk, Sadar Bazaar, Khari Baoli, Naya Bazaar, Gandhi Nagar and Karol Bagh for their contribution to the country's economy. She said the Delhi government is working to create a transparent and business-friendly ecosystem by improving ease of doing business, promoting digitisation, upgrading infrastructure and modernising markets.

Delhi's new trails

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, 14 August

Delhi Tourism took media professionals and social media influencers on a familiarisation tour of the first of four newly curated spiritual and heritage tourism circuits, offering a glimpse of the Capital beyond its conventional tourist landmarks. The four circuits connect 21 prominent spiritual, religious, cultural and heritage destinations across Delhi.

The familiarisation tour covered Gurudwara Bangla Sahib, Sacred Heart Cathedral, Agrasen ki Baoli, Lotus Temple and Swaminarayan Akshardham Temple. Delhi Tourism arranged tourist guides at the sites, where the history, architecture and significance of the locations were explained to the visitors. The entire experience was organised and taken care of by Delhi Tourism, allowing participants to experience the spiritual, cultural, historical and architectural significance of the destinations first-hand.

The initiative has been jointly taken forward by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Tourism Minister Shri Kapil Mishra as part of the Delhi Government's effort to place Delhi on the global tourism map by integrating its spiritual, cultural and historical heritage. The initiative aims to transform Delhi from a "transit city" into a "destination city". The four circuits were announced by the Chief Minister at the Spiritual and Heritage Tourism Conclave 2026 held on August 11 at Swaminarayan Akshardham Temple, under the theme "Delhi: The Capital of Spirituality, Heritage and Experiences". The first circuit, 'The Soul of Delhi', includes Agrasen ki Baoli, Lotus Temple, Akshardham Temple, Gurudwara Bangla Sahib and Sacred Heart Cathedral. The Lotus Temple, which has completed 40 years, is also notable as a similar structure is set to come up in Bihar.

The other three circuits 'The Heritage of Delhi', 'Delhi's Sacred Harmony' and 'Echoes of Delhi' bring together Birla Temple, Jhandewalan Mata Mandir, Jantar Mantar, Yogmaya Mandir, Jagannath Temple, Praacheen Hanuman Mandir, Digambar Jain Lal Mandir, Ambedkar Memorial, Purana Qila, Hazrat Nizamuddin, Gurudwara Rakab Ganj Sahib, Buddhist Temple, Church of the Redemption, Mehrauli Archaeological Park, Chhatarpur Mandir and Linga Bhairavi Sannidhanam.

Remembering Partition Horrors

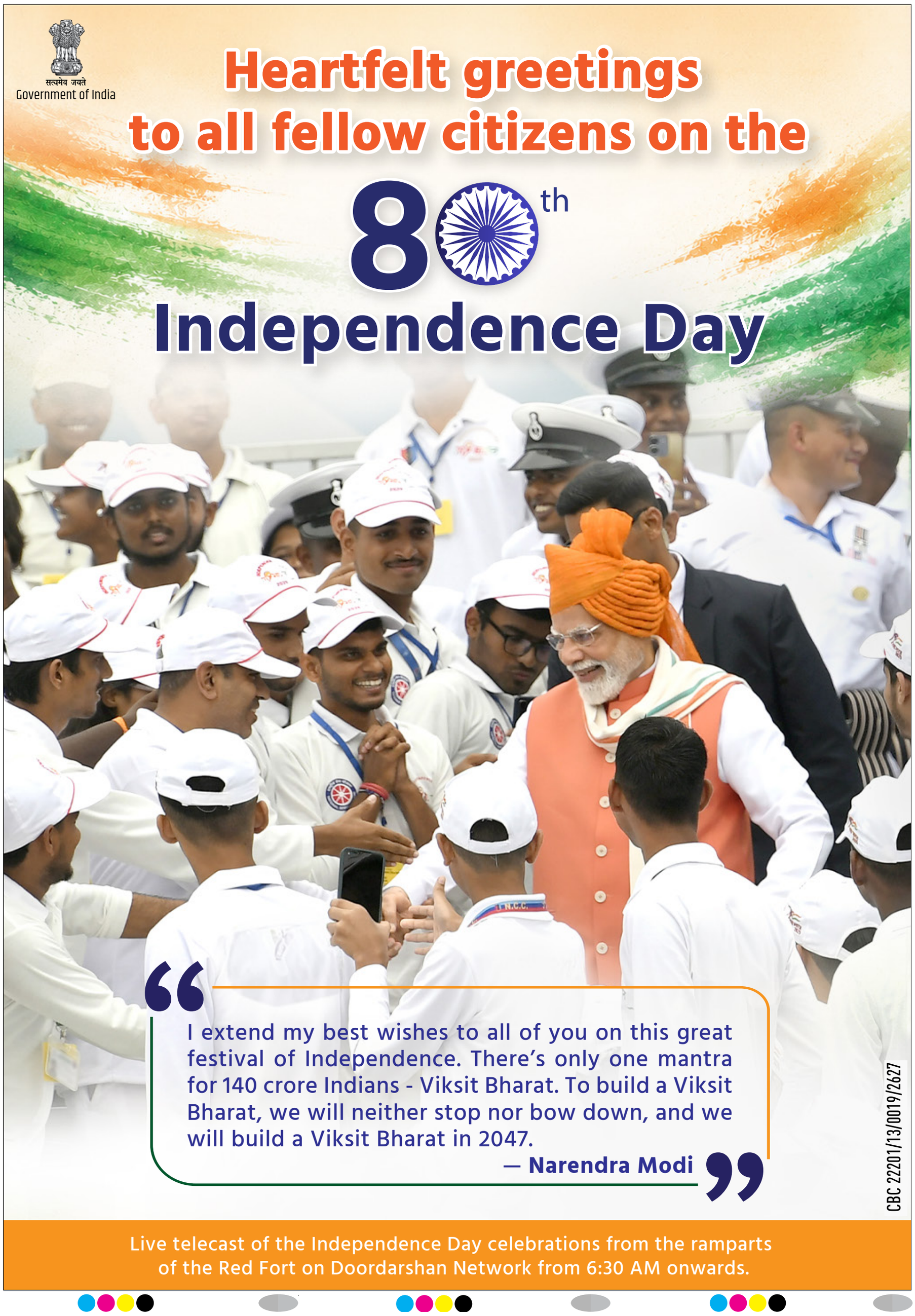
OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 14 August

The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation on Friday inaugurated special exhibitions at Rajiv Chowk and Kashmere Gate Metro stations to mark Partition Horrors Remembrance Day, observed annually on August 14. The exhibitions, which will remain open to the public till August 21, aim to familiarise commuters with the human tragedy of the 1947 Partition and its lasting impact on the country. According to DMRC, the displays depict the suffering, displacement and loss experienced by millions of people during Partition through a curated visual presentation. The exhibitions have been organised at two of the capital's busiest interchange stations to ensure that a large number of commuters can access them.

Assembly throws open its doors...

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 14 August

The Delhi Legislative Assembly opened its doors to the public on Friday evening as part of the celebrations marking the eve of the country's 80th Independence Day, with Speaker Vijender Gupta extending greetings to citizens and urging every household to hoist the Tricolour under the 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign. The 115-year-old Assembly building was illuminated in the colours of the national flag, drawing large crowds of visitors, including families and young people, who explored the historic premises and participated in the patriotic celebrations. The Assembly remained open to the public from 5 pm to 8 pm.



KEN-BETWA LINK PROJECT ISSUE

Most eligible families have received full compensation, says Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

The government on Friday dismissed as "incorrect and misleading" allegations that tribal families were being displaced without compensation in certain areas of Madhya Pradesh due to the Ken-Betwa Link Project.

The Jal Shakti Ministry said reports about symbolic protests such as "chita andolan", "fansi pradarshan" and "jal satyagraha" against the project were misleading.

"The allegations that affected families have not been compensated or rehabilitated are incorrect and misleading. Most eligible families have received full compensation and rehabilitation benefits, and only procedural formalities remain in a few cases," it said. The ministry's statement comes amid protests by tribal communities and farmers in Madhya Pradesh's Panna and Chhatarpur districts over rehabilitation and compensation under the Ken-Betwa Link Project.

Several videos purportedly showing the protests have also been widely shared on social media.

Protesters have used symbolic forms of protest, including "chita andolan", "fansi pradarshan" and "jal satyagraha", and have raised concerns over the identification of beneficiaries and the project's impact on the Panna Tiger Reserve. The ministry said the Centre, Madhya Pradesh government and the Ken-Betwa Link Project Authority remain committed to ensuring transparent, just and time-bound compensation and dignified rehabilitation for all genuinely affected families.

The ministry also claimed that the names of individuals participating in recent protests do not appear in the list of project-affected families, land records or compensation registers. "These activities are largely being conducted by external elements with the intent to circulate misleading and factually incorrect narratives regarding the project," it said.

The Ken-Betwa Link Project, India's first major river-linking initiative under the National Perspective Plan, aims to transfer surplus water from the Ken River to the Betwa River to provide irrigation, drinking water and hydropower benefits to the Bundelkhand region of Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, the ministry said.

The project will ensure irrigation for 10.62 lakh hectares, drinking water for nearly 62 lakh people and 103 MW of hydropower generation. Of the total estimated cost of Rs 44,604.99 crore, Rs 12,445.85 crore has been spent up to July 2026. The project is being implemented by the Ken-Betwa Link Project Authority.

Land acquisition, rehabilitation and resettlement activities are being carried out in accordance with the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (RFCTLARR) Act, 2013, and the special rehabilitation package approved by the Madhya Pradesh government on September 13, 2023.

"Compensation for acquired land is being provided either as per the Act or at Rs 12.50 lakh per hectare, whichever is higher. Compensation for houses, trees, wells, tube wells and other immovable assets has been determined as per statutory provisions," the ministry said. Eligible families are being provided Rs 7 lakh for rural plots and Rs 6.50 lakh for urban plots, while those opting out of plots receive Rs 12.50 lakh as one-time assistance, it said. Additional financial support is being extended to eligible Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe families in Scheduled Areas to ensure a fair and balanced rehabilitation process, it said. As of July, awards amounting to Rs 360.66 crore have been passed for 10,913 affected persons, of which Rs 320.45 crore (88.85 per cent) has already been disbursed.

Tribals and farmers affected by the Ken-Betwa river-linking project stage a symbolic 'hanging satyagraha', in Chhatarpur district, Madhya Pradesh PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Several videos purportedly showing the protests ave also been widely shared on social media**
- **'The Ken-Betwa Link Project, India's first major river-linking initiative aims to transfer surplus water from the Ken River to the Betwa River to provide irrigation, drinking water and hydropower benefits to Bundelkhand region**

From page 1

NALSAR

said they would be empanelled for legal aid cases. It also ordered that no punitive action be taken against students or faculty at the instance of the BCI or any state bar council.

The court issued notice to the BCI and sought its response within two weeks, posting the matter for hearing after two weeks. BCI counsel informed the bench that the circular had already been withdrawn.

The initial BCI communication, issued by chairperson Manan Kumar Mishra, said the council was examining allegations of a campaign against Kant's participation in the convocation and had sought a report identifying those involved. It had said a final decision would be taken on August 19. Following an uproar on social media, the BCI modified its order, saying the "vast majority" of students were innocent and should not suffer for the alleged misconduct of a few. It also said some teachers and outsiders had allegedly instigated students.

Kant's remarks came amid a separate controversy over social media clips of his May 15 court proceedings. In an interview with DD News, he said his remarks comparing people with fraudulent degrees to "cockroaches" had been misquoted and misused to mislead youth.

He also urged responsible media reporting and said judicial live-streaming should not be commercially exploited through unauthorised clips. The CJI said transparency remained important, but live-streaming should not be misused for personal or commercial gain.

Caste enters

for work.

The Census will also collect details on birthplace, previous residence, reason for migration, duration of stay after migration and permanent address. Married, widowed, divorced and separated women will be asked about surviving children, children from their current marriage and children born alive during the previous year.

Several questions are new to the Census, including mobile number, Aadhaar number, Voter ID and passport details, where applicable. Enumerators will also record whether respondents hold a driving licence, where they received their Covid-19 vaccination and the number of bank accounts they have.

The number of population-enumeration questions has increased from 22 in 1981 to 23 each in 1991 and 2001, and 29 in 2011. Census 2027 adds 11 questions to the previous count.

The decision to include caste was taken by the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on April 30 last year. The government has approved Rs 11,718 crore for the Census.

The first phase, house listing and housing operations, began earlier this year and is scheduled to continue until September 30. Enumerators are mapping structures, houses and households and collecting information through 33 questions covering housing conditions and basic facilities. By late June, the exercise had been completed in 23 states and Union territories, while field operations were continuing in several others.

Census 2027 will be conducted digitally through a dedicated mobile application, although door-to-door enumeration will remain available for those who do not use self-enumeration. The Census, originally scheduled for 2021, was postponed because of the Covid-19 pandemic.

President amid protests

recent nationwide Gen Z and student-led protests demanding systemic overhauls, fast-track investigations, and stringent legal action following high-profile paper leak irregularities in competitive examinations.

Highlighting the spirit of enterprise among young citizens, she said youths are increasingly embracing a culture of job creation rather than job seeking.

The President's Independence Day Eve address touched on national security, terrorism, India's response to Pakistan, economic growth, poverty reduction, food security, development in Naxal-affected areas and access to justice.

President Murmu also lauded the "unmatched valour" of the Indian Armed Forces, saying Operation Sindoor demonstrated the country's capability to execute precision counter-terror operations and sent a firm message that terror elements and their backers will face consequences regardless of where they hide.

She recalled the anniversary of the military action alongside historic observances like Kargil Vijay Diwas, reaffirming India's tradition of overcoming forces hostile to humanity.

She said the operation delivered an unequivocal warning to enemies. "It sent a clear and firm message to terrorists and those who support them that no matter where they hide, they will have to face the consequences of their actions."

The President also highlighted the strategic measures accompanying the counter-terror posture, describing the decision to suspend the Indus Waters Treaty with the nation harbouring terror networks as a "decisive step in the interest of our nation, especially the farmers".

On internal security, she termed the eradication of Naxalism a monumental achievement for the country after decades of struggle.

"For decades, Naxalism posed a serious challenge to the nation. Making India Naxal free is a major achievement. Today, enthusiasm prevails in the areas once affected by Naxalism," she said, pointing to all-inclusive development efforts and active local participation in initiatives like the Bastar Olympics and the Bastar Pandum festival.

Addressing foreign policy, she reiterated that peace, dialogue, cooperation, and the ideal of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam' (the world is one family) remain the bedrock of India's international relations.

"We believe in a rules-based international order. Our endeavour is to ensure that the global community receives appropriate representation in the United Nations and other multilateral organisations," she stated, noting India's growing stature among Global South nations.

The President also touched upon senior care, pointing out that alongside the world's largest young population, India is also seeing a rise in senior citizens and noted that about six crore senior citizens aged 70 and above can now avail of free healthcare services up to Rs 5 lakh per year under government initiatives, urging society to remain sensitive and uphold their dignity.

Underlining India's technological leap, she pointed out that the country has developed the world's largest and best digital infrastructure, accounting for more than half of global real-time digital transactions.

Highlighting the demographic dividend, the President said that 65 per cent of the country's population is below the age of 35, describing the youth as India's "most valuable asset".

She commended young entrepreneurs for driving a robust startup ecosystem and lauded young innovators, citing a recent space exploration milestone led by a team with an average age of just 28 years.

MEA

foreign policy, which he claimed was all about hugging leaders.

The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha also said it has somehow been ingrained in Modi's mind that foreign policy is all about hugging leaders.

Gandhi then hugged Dikshit in a bid to demonstrate what the current government's foreign policy was about. "Imagine the ignorance... where did he get the idea that foreign policy was about hugging leaders," he said.

Dikshit then asked Gandhi, "Ek cheez pooch sakta hoon? Meloni samajh ke toh nahi pakda tha?" Gandhi responded by saying, "I have not reached there yet."

The BJP slammed Gandhi for mocking PM Modi's handling of foreign policy and accused the Congress MP of using "uncultured and indecent" language and lowering the dignity of the office of the Leader of Opposition.

Union Education Minister Pralhad Joshi, among the first BJP leaders to respond on the matter, questioned when Rahul Gandhi would "grow up".

"Rahul Gandhi, when will you grow up? Running India requires mature leadership, not amateur dramatics. Calling a democratically elected government 'jokers and clowns' proves you are out of your depth," Joshi said.

"The Prime Minister is an elected leader. Unlike Rahul Gandhi and his family, he did not ascend through a hierarchy, nor did he rise due to family lineage or dynastic politics. The words being used, the level to which one is stooping, reflect sheer stupidity and frustration on Rahul Gandhi's part. It is this frustration that drives him to use abusive language," Joshi said, adding that by insulting the prime minister, Gandhi had insulted the people of India.

NCB brings

against narcotics.

The case originated in Pune in 2024, when police seized 500 grams of Mephedrone, a synthetic stimulant also known as "meow meow", and arrested three people. The investigation was later expanded using a "top-to-bottom and bottom-to-top" approach to trace the wider network. About 867 kg of Mephedrone was recovered in Pune and another 970 kg in Delhi, taking the total to approximately 1,837 kg.

The NCB Mumbai unit identified Basoya as an alleged foreign-based mastermind who coordinated the syndicate from overseas and facilitated the movement of Mephedrone from India to other countries. The Home Ministry said the 970-kg Delhi consignment was allegedly linked to preparations for export through courier channels associated with him.

Basoya also surfaced in a Delhi Police Special Cell case involving international cocaine trafficking. In October 2024, coordinated raids in Delhi, Hapur, Ghaziabad and Ankleshwar in Gujarat led to the recovery of more than 1,300 kg of cocaine, Mephedrone and hydroponic weed. Investigators alleged that Basoya coordinated the procurement, transportation, storage and distribution of cocaine and other drugs.

NCB Deputy Director General (Operations) Neeraj Gupta said Basoya fled to Dubai a day after the Pune case was registered. An Interpol Red Notice against him was issued in November 2025. Gupta described him as a "big kingpin" and said Basoya also faces a 2009 Directorate of Revenue Intelligence case in which he had been jailed and where a chargesheet is pending before a court.

The repatriation was carried out under Operation GLOBAL-HUNT, the NCB initiative to locate major drug traffickers and fugitives abroad through international cooperation, including Interpol mechanisms. The agency said two other fugitives, Mohammad Salim Dola of Türkiye and Navin Chichkar of Malaysia, have also been apprehended.

The NCB said the action is in line with its Vision Document on Drug Control (2026-2029), under which it will continue pursuing drug kingpins, financiers, handlers and fugitives operating within India and overseas.

US accuses

"For years, the great transshipment scam has let Communist China launder its exports through more than 40 countries," Navarro told reporters.

The network, according to the report, includes major US trading partners such as Mexico, Canada, the European Union, India, Japan and South Korea. Navarro said Chinese companies used third countries for limited processing, relabelling, repackaging, reinvoicing or changes in routing to make goods appear to have originated outside China, while much of the Chinese content remained unchanged.

The report said such routes allowed Chinese manufacturers and trading firms to use locations with lower labour costs, weaker customs checks, free zones and preferential access to the US market.

India's Pune-Gujarat-Chennai production belt was specifically cited for its role in absorbing Chinese-made pumps and compressors, with the report linking the practice to industrial supply chains in Cincinnati, Dayton and Columbus. "A Chinese pump that leaves Pune as Indian is a pump not machined in Cincinnati, Dayton or Columbus," Navarro said.

The report estimated the annual value of illegally transshipped goods at between about USD 40 billion and USD 303 billion, depending on the methodology and definition used. Navarro also announced an AI-based system called "Detective Border". It will assist US Customs and Border Protection by analysing shipment data, routing histories, product classifications, ownership links, production capacity and anomalies, along with computer vision tools.

The system is intended to help authorities distinguish legitimate foreign investment and nearshoring from illegal pass-through trade and support shipment interceptions, duty collection, penalties and exclusions.

Rahul

the CrPC had not been obtained to prosecute an offence under Section 153A of the IPC, which deals with promoting enmity between groups.

The case arose from comments made by Gandhi at a rally in Maharashtra's Akola district on November 17, 2022, during his Bharat Jodo Yatra. Advocate Nripendra Pandey had accused him of deliberately insulting Savarkar as part of a "well-planned conspiracy" to defame him.

"Additional Solicitor General and advocate for complainant... submits there is no disclosure of sanction. In such view of the matter, the complaint and orders passed by the magistrate stand quashed," the bench said.

The Supreme Court had earlier called Gandhi's remarks "irresponsible" and said, "Let's not mock our freedom fighters," while staying the proceedings.

The Allahabad High Court had on April 4, 2025 refused to quash the trial court's summons. Gandhi had challenged that order and the ongoing proceedings.

Govt to scrap

Rule 7(11) of the Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994, allows up to 10 minutes of commercial advertising and two minutes of self-promotional content in an hour. The amendment will take effect after it is notified in the Gazette.

The ministry said the rule was introduced in 2006, when India had only 62 television channels, compared with more than 900 today. It also noted that television remains heavily dependent on advertising across both pay and free-to-air channels, while digital platforms face no similar advertising-duration limit. The decision comes months after the Delhi High Court upheld the existing cap. In May, a bench of Justices Anil Kshetarpal and Amit Mahajan dismissed challenges by general entertainment, news and regional broadcasters.

The court had said the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India acted within its authority in setting the "10+2 minutes per clock hour" ceiling. It also held that spectrum and airwaves were scarce public resources and observed that there was "no constitutional guarantee of profitability or unlimited monetisation of public resources". The ministry said the amendment was intended to "enable fair competition and ensure ease of doing business". MPOST

U'khand's Chamoli

and trapping 22 workers, District Disaster Management Officer N K Joshi said.

According to a State Emergency Operations Centre report, 19 workers were brought out during an overnight rescue operation. Seven died and 12 were injured. The remaining three workers are believed to be trapped about 1.8 kilometres inside the tunnel.

Rescue agencies have deployed heavy machinery to clear debris and pumps to remove water. Continuous rainfall, however, has made the operation difficult.

Garhwal Range Inspector General of Police Rajiv Swaroop said teams were carefully searching the affected section. "The area where the debris has accumulated is flooded, and it is being rapidly removed with the help of machines," he told PTI Videos. He said the rain was creating challenges, but officials remained confident of a successful operation. "We have marked a specific area for the operation, where every square metre is being carefully inspected."

The deceased were identified as Pradeep Panwar, 31, of Tehri Garhwal; Mukesh Singh of Chamoli; Durga Sharma, Vijay Hansda and Jitendra Kumar of Uttar Pradesh; and Lokeshwar and Bhuneshwar of Chhattisgarh.

The missing workers are Lucas Topno of Jharkhand, and Chetan Poyam and Devnath of Chhattisgarh.

Among the injured, Sunil Dewan, Harbil Gudiya, Kamda, Nirshtar Bhingra, Vinod Rawna, Dina Begra, Khela Ram Bisra, Subeg Singh, Tilakraj and Pen Singh are being treated at the district hospital in Gopeshwar. Harbil Gudiya, Kamda, Nirshtar Bhingra, Vinod Rawna, Dina Begra and Khela Ram Bisra are from Jharkhand, Subeg Singh from Punjab, Tilakraj from Himachal Pradesh, and Sunil Dewan and Pen Singh from Chhattisgarh.

Rohit Pandey of Bihar was shifted to Base Hospital in Srinagar, Pauri Garhwal, while Govindo Mandal of West Bengal was discharged after treatment. Doctors and health department teams are monitoring the injured.

Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami visited Pipalkoti and reviewed the rescue operation before visiting the injured at the Chamoli district hospital. He sought details from District Magistrate Gaurav Kumar and Superintendent of Police Surjeet Singh Panwar and entered the tunnel to assess the operation.

Dhami directed agencies to use available resources and technical expertise and maintain coordination to safely evacuate the missing workers. "Arrangements have also been made at AIIMS, Rishikesh, in case anyone should be shifted there. All agencies such as NDRF, SDRF, ITBP, Uttarakhand Disaster Management Department are involved in rescue work," he said. The NDRF, SDRF, ITBP, police and specialist technical teams are involved in the operation. Kumar, along with Garhwal MP Anil Baluni, is monitoring the rescue effort at the site.

The accident has also recalled the November 12, 2023 tunnel collapse at Silkarya-Barkot in Uttarkashi, where 41 workers were trapped. They were rescued safely on November 28 after a nearly 17-day operation involving Central and state agencies and international experts.

NATION TO MARK 80TH INDEPENDENCE DAY

Red Fort to witness maiden rendition of 'Vande Mataram'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

The nation will commemorate the 80th Independence Day on August 15, a red-letter day in the history of India, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi set to lead the celebrations at the Red Fort complex amid patriotic fervour and multi-layer security.

For the first time, the National Song, 'Vande Mataram', will be rendered during the Independence Day celebrations at the Red Fort.

Ceremonial events are scheduled to be held at state capitals and other cities and towns across the country, which will include flag-hoisting followed by cultural performances.

The main function will be held at the Red Fort complex and Prime Minister Modi will lead the celebrations.

The mega function is set to commemorate 150 years of the enduring legacy of the National Song, 'Vande Mataram', and "celebrate the energy, aspirations and pivotal contribution of 'Yuva Shakti' in driving India's journey towards Viksit Bharat by 2047", the defence ministry said on Thursday.

Upon his arrival at the Red Fort, Modi will be received by Defence minister Rajnath Singh, his deputy Sanjay Seth and Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh.

The defence secretary will introduce the General Officer Commanding (GOC), Delhi Area, Lt Gen Rajesh Sethi, to the Prime Minister.

The GOC will then conduct the prime minister to the saluting base where a combined Inter-Services and Delhi Police Guard will present general salute to PM Modi. Thereafter, the prime minister will inspect the guard of honour, the ministry earlier said in a statement.

The Guard of Honour contingent for the prime minister will consist of one officer and 24 personnel each from the Army, Navy, Air Force and the Delhi Police.

A full-dress rehearsal of the event was held at the Red Fort on Thursday.

The Indian Army is the coordinating service for the Independence Day celebrations this year. The guard of honour will be commanded by Lt Col Arjun Singh. The Army contingent in the Prime Minister's Guard will be commanded by Maj Aditya Sharma, the naval contingent by Lt Cdr Neelam Rana and the Air Force contingent by Sqn Ldr Vipin Kumar. The Delhi Police contingent will be commanded by Additional DCP Vineet Kumar, it said.

Delhi Police officials during the full-dress rehearsal for the 80th Independence Day, near Red Fort in New Delhi PTI

CLOSER LOOK

- Ceremonial events are scheduled to be held at state capitals and other cities and towns across the country
- mega function said that is set to commemorate 150 years of the enduring legacy of the National Song, 'Vande Mataram'

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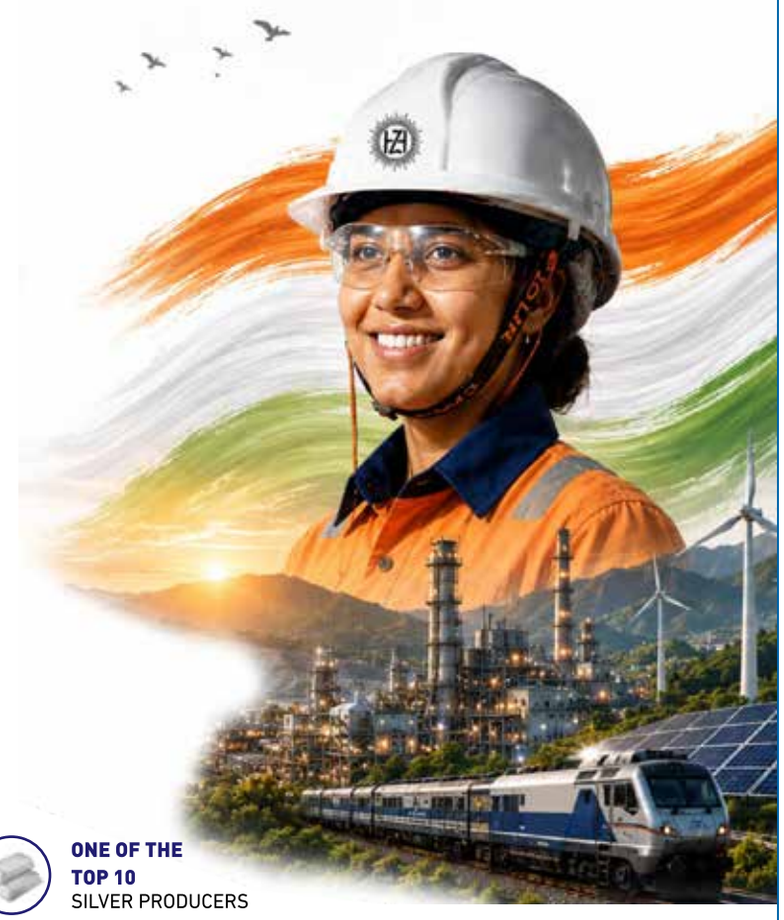

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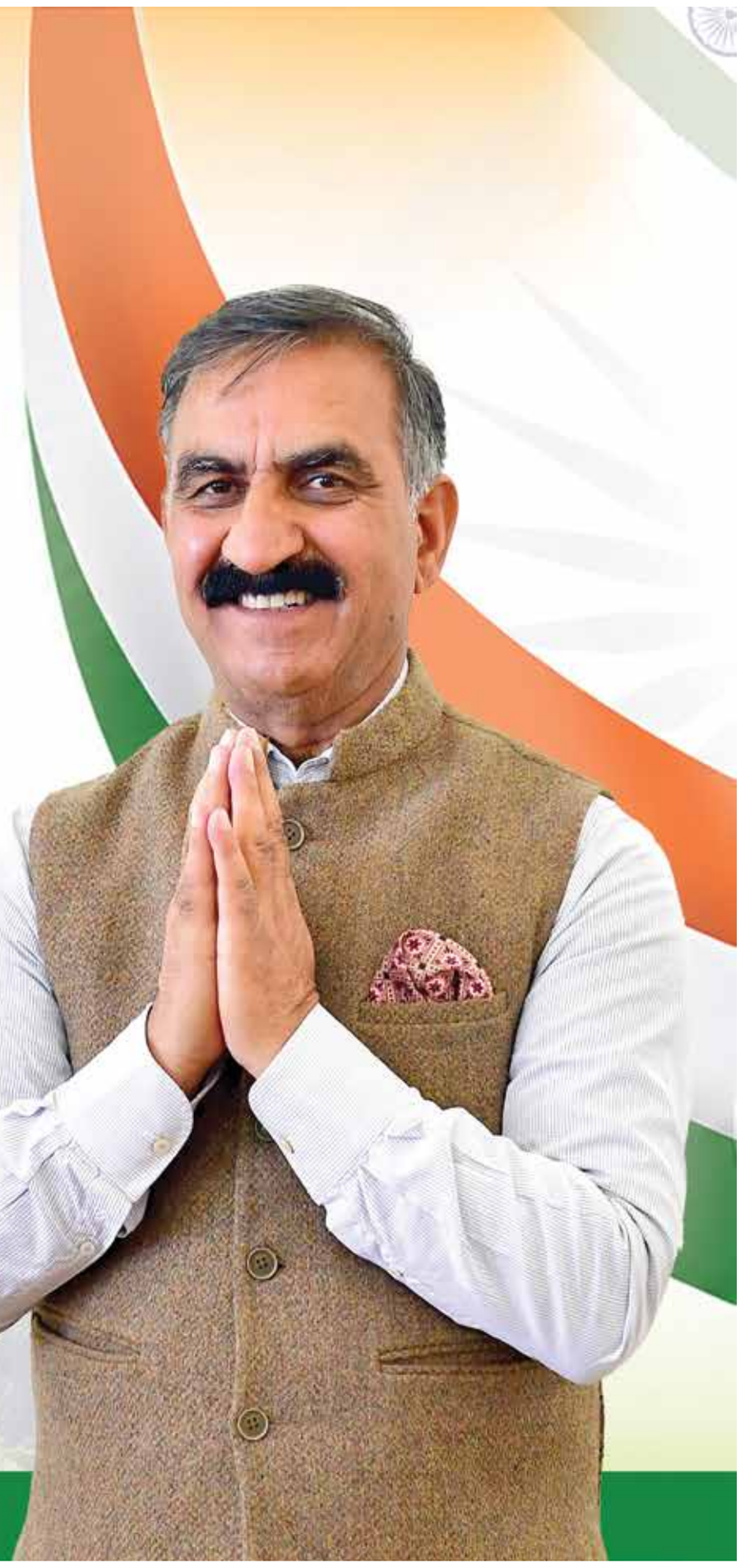
सभी प्रदेशवासियों को
स्वतंत्रता दिवस
की हार्दिक शुभकामनाएं

स्वतंत्रता दिवस राष्ट्र के गौरव, स्वाभिमान और अमर बलिदानों के स्मरण का प्रेरणादायी पर्व है। हम अपने महापुरुषों से राष्ट्रभक्ति की प्रेरणा लेकर प्रदेश के विकास, समृद्धि एवं खुशहाली के लिए मिलकर कार्य करें तथा हिमाचल के हित को सर्वोपरि रखें।

जय हिंद, जय हिमाचल

सुखविन्द्र सिंह सुक्खू
मुख्यमंत्री, हिमाचल प्रदेश



सूचना एवं जन सम्पर्क विभाग, हिमाचल प्रदेश

Briefs

JP Nadda 'stable' after angiography

NEW DELHI: Union Health Minister J P Nadda was admitted to AIIMS Delhi after he experienced uneasiness, the hospital said on Friday.

Nadda underwent a coronary angiography after being admitted on Thursday. He is currently stable and admitted for observation in the cardiology department, it said.

Nadda was evaluated for uneasiness with tests, including a coronary angiography on the evening of August 13. He is currently "stable" and under observation.

Hooda urges calm in Panjokhra...

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda urged the government to handle the Gurudwara Panjokhra Sahib situation in Ambala with sensitivity and impartiality.

He called for dialogue and restraint instead of police force and legal cases. Hooda urged withdrawal of cases against Sikh Sangat, Haryana Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee members and farmers.

'DECLASSIFIED: OPERATION SINDOOR'

India's tolerance should not be mistaken for weakness: Doval

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 14

National Security Advisor Ajit Doval has said India's generosity and tolerance should not be mistaken for weakness, asserting that the country can take risks and hit hard, irrespective of the consequences.

Speaking in an upcoming docuseries, Doval said the objective of the 88-hour military operation was to destroy enemy camps, particularly those responsible for the Pahalgam terror attack.

"We had decided the objective of the operation as destruction of the enemy camps particularly those who had been responsible for the Pahalgam attack," Doval said in his first interview since Operation Sindoor.

"Message to the world is very clear - India's generosity or India being tolerant should not be mistaken for its weakness. India can take risks, India can hit hard, irrespective of the consequences," he added.

The two-part Discovery docuseries, "Declassified: Operation Sindoor", brings together India's military and national security leadership to recount the decisions and events surrounding Operation Sindoor, with first-hand accounts from those who oversaw India's response, Discovery said in a statement.

NSA Ajit Doval FILE PIC

INSIGHT

- Doval said the objective of the 88-hour military operation was to destroy enemy camps, particularly those responsible for the Pahalgam terror attack
- India can take risks, India can hit hard, irrespective of the consequences, Doval said
- The NSA recalled meeting PM Modi, who was in Saudi when the Pahalgam attack happened and had to cut short his visit
- 'When the PM says that Op Sindoor is alive, his intention is that the fight against terror will only be over till the last terrorist is eliminated,' he said

In the show, Doval offers an account of the decision-making and resolve behind the military response, it added.

The NSA recalled meeting Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who was in Saudi Arabia when the Pahalgam terror attack happened and had to cut short his visit.

"Prime Minister returned. Foreign Secretary had come to receive him. Then at the airport itself we had a meeting. First he wanted to know all the facts. And then his first question to me was -- 'Who has done it? Who is responsible? We should be very clear who the perpetrators are. I want it immediately.'

"Thanks to our intelligence agencies, I think they did a brilliant job, and within a very short time, we were able to arrive at the conclusion," he said.

Doval said they wanted Pakistan Army to realise that its "support to terrorism or inability to take effective action against the terrorists is something which is not tolerable to us".

Operation Sindoor was launched early on May 7 last year to avenge the deadly April 22 Pahalgam terror attack, in which 26 people were killed, with Indian armed forces conducting precision strikes on multiple terror infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK).

Pakistan later also launched offensives against India, and all subsequent counter-offensives by India were also carried out under Operation Sindoor.

The military conflict between the two nuclear-armed neighbours, lasting nearly 88 hours, halted after they reached an understanding on the evening of May 10.

"Once anything starts, we are willing to go as far as it is necessary for a nation to preserve its sovereignty and there are no limits on that. We fight till the last drop of blood," he said.

Doval further said: "When the Prime Minister says that Operation Sindoor is alive, his intention is that the fight against terror will only be over till the last terrorist is eliminated."

J'khand exam stir enters 21st day, stage set for Tiranga Yatra

Protestors burn effigies of 'education mafia'

MPOST BUREAU
Ranchi, August 14

The agitation by students demanding reforms in Jharkhand's recruitment examination process entered its 21st day on Friday, with officials meeting protesters at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium amid plans for their 'Tiranga Yatra' on Independence Day.

Officials sought details of the route proposed for their 'Tiranga Yatra' on August 15.

Meanwhile, 'JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch' leader Ravindra Paswan said the protesters were ready for talks whenever the government invited them for negotiations.

Earlier on Friday, students marched from Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium to Albert Ekka Chowk and burnt effigies of the "education mafia" and those accused by protesters of patronising them. Paswan said the demonstration was aimed at pressing the government to act against those allegedly responsible for irregularities in recruitment examinations.

Students and aspirants raise slogans during a protest at Albert Ekka Chowk, in Ranchi, Friday PTI

The protesters are seeking greater transparency, cancellation of several examinations and an independent probe by the CBI or a panel of retired judges from outside Jharkhand.

They have also objected to the FIR registered after clashes during their August 10 march towards the Jharkhand Assembly. The FIR names around 300 unidentified people for allegedly violating prohibitory orders, damaging government property and attacking police personnel. Fourteen policemen were injured, while police said no arrests had been made.

The agitation has also involved hunger strikes. Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha leader Devendra Nath Mahto has been fasting for 13 days and was admitted to Sadar Hospital on August 10. Four other protesting students on hunger strike are also undergoing treatment.

Mann lays CBG plant's foundation

MPOST BUREAU
Ludhiana, August 14

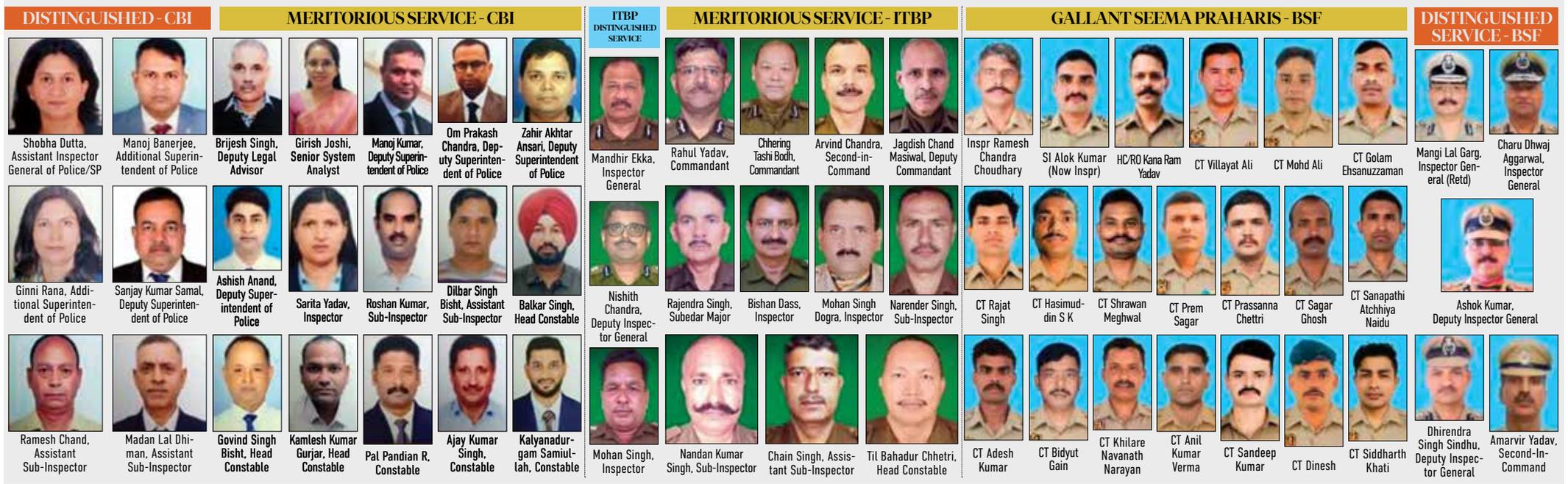
Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Friday laid the foundation stone of a Rs 65-crore compressed biogas (CBG) plant at Ludhiana's Haibowal.

The project will help address sewer blockage and pollution in the Budha Nallah here by scientifically processing 300 tonnes of cattle dung generated daily at the dairy complex, officials said.

Being developed on 2.5 acres and scheduled to become operational by September 2027, the plant will also provide 435 dairy owners new income opportunities under the 'Waste-to-Wealth' mission, besides producing around five tonnes of CBG and organic bio-fertiliser every day.

In a post on X, Mann stated, "Today, laid the foundation stone of the Rs 65-crore Compressed Bio-Gas (CBG) Plant at Haibowal, Ludhiana, which will be ready by September 2027. Under the 'Waste-to-Wealth' mission, the plant will scientifically process 300 tonnes of cattle dung every day. This will prevent waste from entering the Budha Nallah, help resolve the problem of sewer blockages..."

PRESIDENT'S MEDAL FOR DISTINGUISHED SERVICE & MEDAL FOR MERITORIOUS SERVICE



Gallantry Medals to 301 Police, Fire personnel

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 14

A total of 1,057 personnel from the Police, Fire Service, Civil Defence and Home Guard, and Correctional Services have been recommended for Gallantry and Service medals on the eve of Independence Day 2026.

The recommendations include 301 personnel for Gallantry Medals (GM), 92 for President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) and 664 for Medals for Meritorious Service (MSM).

Gallantry Medals are awarded for acts of bravery in saving lives and property, preventing crime or apprehending criminals while facing risks to life and limb. Of the 301 GMs, 272 have been recommended for police personnel and 29 for fire service personnel. Among these, 197 medals are for personnel serving in Left Wing Extremism-affected areas, 51 in Jammu and Kashmir, 12 in the Northeast and 41 in other areas.

Of the 92 PSMs recommended for distinguished service beyond routine duties, 83 are for police personnel, four for fire service personnel, three for Civil Defence and Home Guard personnel, and two for Correctional Services personnel.

The 664 MSMs recognise valuable service involving a high degree of skill, devotion to duty and risks to life and limb. These include 606 medals for police personnel, 28 for fire service personnel, 18 for Civil Defence and Home Guard personnel, and 12 for Correctional Services personnel.

'19 DEATHS IN 5 MONTHS'

NHRC seeks report on CRPF personnel suicides

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

THE NHRC HAS ISSUED NOTICES TO THE UNION HOME SECRETARY AND THE CRPF DIRECTOR GENERAL, SEEKING THEIR RESPONSES WITHIN TWO WEEKS

The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has taken cognisance of a media report about 19 CRPF personnel dying by suicide within five months and sought a detailed report from the authorities concerned.

The NHRC has issued notices to the Union Home Secretary and the Director General of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), seeking their responses within two weeks. The Commission said the allegations, if proved, could affect the right to life of personnel serving in the Central Armed Police Forces.

According to the report published on August 11, 2026, as many as 281 CRPF personnel died by suicide in the past five years, including more than 216 who were on duty.

The data cited in the report showed 57 suicide deaths among CRPF personnel in 2021, 43 in 2022, 57 in 2023, 46 in 2024 and 59 in 2025. The 2025 figure was reported to be the highest since 2021.

The NHRC has sought information on the circumstances surrounding the deaths and the measures taken by the Ministry of Home Affairs and CRPF to safeguard the welfare and security of personnel.

The Commission's move comes amid concerns over stress and strain among Central Armed Police Forces personnel, many of whom are deployed in conflict-affected and difficult areas across the country.

'VYAVASTHA PARIVARTAN DELIVERING RESULTS'

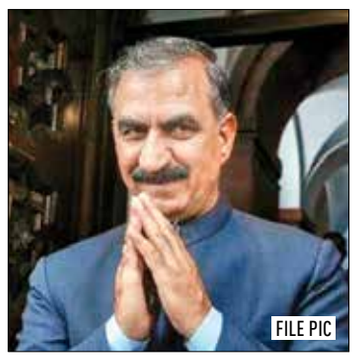
Working to make HP India's richest state: Sukhu

MPOST BUREAU
Shimla, August 14

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, in his Independence Day message, highlighted the state government's initiatives over the past three years and eight months, saying it was working towards making Himachal Pradesh the country's richest state by 2030 while strengthening its financial position and ensuring inclusive development.

Sukhu said the government's "Vyavastha Parivartan" agenda was aimed at ensuring that development reached every section of society. He said the state's per capita income had risen from Rs 2,14,952 in 2022-23 to Rs 2,83,626 in 2025-26.

Highlighting efforts to secure Himachal's financial interests, he said the state's free power share from the Karcham-Wangtoo project had increased from 12 per cent to 18 per cent, generating an additional Rs 150 crore annually. The restoration of ownership of Wildflower Hall brought Rs 450 crore to the state treasury, while the Kishau dam project was expected to generate around Rs 600 crore annually.



FILE PIC

KEY POINTS

- Sukhu said the govt's 'Vyavastha Parivartan' agenda was aimed at ensuring that development reached every section of society
- He said the state's per capita income had risen from Rs 2,14,952 in 2022-23 to Rs 2,83,626 in 2025-26
- He said the govt would continue working towards economic self-reliance, better public services and opportunities for youth

The government, he said, was also pursuing the recovery of Rs 7,200 crore owed by the Bhakra Beas Management Board and seeking Himachal's 7.19 per cent share in Chandigarh.

On agriculture and rural livelihoods, Sukhu said cow milk procurement had been increased to Rs 61 per litre and buffalo milk to Rs 71. A Rs. 250-crore automated milk plant at Dagwar in Kangra is expected to process 1.5 lakh litres daily from December. The government is also promoting natural farming, with higher support prices for wheat, maize, turmeric and ginger.

He said the government was giving priority to education and healthcare. Himachal had achieved 100 per cent literacy and improved its national ranking in quality education from 21st in 2021 to fifth. CBSE-pattern education has been introduced in 156 government schools, attracting more than 24,000 students from private schools. Robotic surgery facilities have also been introduced at major government hospitals, while nearly Rs 3,000 crore is being invested in medical machinery and equipment.

The Chief Minister also highlighted welfare measures, including financial assistance for extremely poor families, monthly support for eligible women, free electricity, housing assistance and benefits for children without family support. Around 6,000 such children have been adopted as "Children of the State" under the Mukhya Mantri Sukh-Aashray Yojana.

On employment, he said 2,061 Van Mitra posts had been filled and another 7,500 posts approved. The government was also expanding electric public transport, with 507 electric buses currently operating.

Sukhu said the government was committed to tackling drug abuse through the Chitta-Mukt Himachal Abhiyan. Under the PIT-NDPS Act, 205 drug traffickers had been detained and 20 properties acquired through drug money demolished.

He said the government would continue working towards economic self-reliance, better public services and opportunities for youth while ensuring that vulnerable sections were not left behind.

EDITORIAL

A journey unfinished

As India marks 80 years of Independence, the distance travelled since 1947 is extraordinary. Yet anniversaries are useful not merely for celebrating achievements but for measuring them against what remains undone. Eight decades after inheriting poverty, poor health, mass illiteracy and a fragile economy, India has acquired economic weight and global influence that would have been difficult to imagine at Independence. The numbers capture this transformation. Life expectancy, barely 32 years in 1951, is now around 72. Literacy has risen from just 18.3 per cent in 1951 to over 80 per cent. India's GDP reached $3.96 trillion in 2025, while foreign exchange reserves provide a formidable cushion against external shocks. From an installed electricity capacity of only 1,362 MW in 1947, the country has built one of the world's largest power systems. More than a billion internet subscriptions demonstrate another revolution altogether – the emergence of a digitally connected India.

These achievements should inspire confidence, but not complacency. A large economy does not automatically translate into widespread prosperity. India's GDP per capita was about $2,703 in 2025, illustrating the considerable distance still separating national economic scale from individual affluence. The benefits of economic expansion must reach far more people if India's development story is to fulfil its promise. Development must ultimately be judged by the quality of everyday life – education that equips children to compete, healthcare that does not impoverish families, secure and productive employment, clean air, safe drinking water and cities capable of accommodating rapid growth. Progress on headline economic indicators cannot substitute for improvements in these fundamental measures of human well-being.

The next stage is arguably harder. The challenge after Independence was to build institutions, industries and infrastructure virtually from scratch. India must now improve their quality while simultaneously negotiating artificial intelligence, climate change, geopolitical instability, trade protectionism and a rapidly transforming labour market. It must generate employment for millions of young people while ensuring that technological disruption does not widen existing inequalities. There is also an important lesson in India's progress. Economic liberalisation, technological adoption, infrastructure expansion and entrepreneurship have accelerated transformation, but the country's democratic institutions and social compact remain equally important assets. Growth that widens opportunity and allows citizens to participate meaningfully in the country's progress will strengthen both.

India at 80, therefore, should neither become an exercise in self-congratulation nor an occasion for habitual pessimism. The statistics establish beyond doubt that the country has achieved a remarkable transformation. They also underline how much more must be accomplished. The centenary of Independence is only two decades away. By 2047, India will be judged not simply by whether it has become one of the world's largest economies, but by whether prosperity has reached ordinary Indians. The first 80 years demonstrated India's capacity to transform. The next 20 must prove its capacity to transform inclusively.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Access Deficit

The parliamentary panel's finding that nearly 73 per cent of students leave before completing higher secondary education is deeply worrying. India urgently needs more secondary schools, accessible infrastructure for Divyang students and special educators to ensure truly inclusive education nationwide.

RAHUL SINGH,
AHMEDABAD

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Safeguarding the Spirit of Bharat

Political independence remains incomplete without the confidence to protect India's cultural inheritance, intellectual freedom and civilisational sense of self

NATION FIRST

ANIRBAN GANGULY

THE WRITER IS MEMBER NEC, BJP & CHAIRMAN, DR SYAMA PRASAD MOOKERJEE RESEARCH FOUNDATION

Protecting freedom also means preserving India's civilisational identity

Launching the 150th anniversary commemoration of Vande Mataram, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had spoken of the ode as the anthem of freedom, which also inspires us on how to protect that freedom.

As India, the "Bharata Shakti" of Sri Aurobindo's dream, completes the 79th year of her independence, the realisation that freedom needs to be protected must occupy and exercise our minds and thoughts.

In his last public message, in December 1948, Sri Aurobindo had also cautioned against India "forfeiting" her "Swadharma" and losing her soul. He spoke of the danger of ancient India's spirit disappearing and of India emerging as just another nation. "Then ancient India and her spirit might disappear altogether and we would have only one more nation like the others and that would be a real gain neither to the world nor to us."

The disappearance of Bharat's essence, its dissolution and change beyond recognition, seemed to Sri Aurobindo to be one of the principal challenges to India's freedom. "It would be a tragic irony of fate," he wrote, "if India were to throw away her spiritual heritage at the very moment when in the rest of the world there is more and more a turning towards her for spiritual help and a saving Light."

The "woke" attitude and approach, which believes in defiling and deconstructing the sense and essence of a value- and norm-based society, is antithetical to the spirit of ancient India that Sri Aurobindo speaks of. The "woke" is emerging as a threat to India's freedom.

It is intolerant of scientific truth and of patriotism. It believes that cultural and social values, traditions and the family system, a civilisation's sacred texts, knowledge systems, national symbols and faith need to be defiled and despoiled.

The "woke" advocates a deconstructionist revolution. It speaks of creating a country and society devoid of sacredness, faith, duty, solidarity, sacrifice and dreams. The "woke" attitude has no need of these, and that is why it is vehement in its opposition to Vande Mataram. Any song or anthem that evokes love and reverence for the Motherland through an emotive contemplation of her various forms and aspirations is anathema to the "woke."

> THE DISAPPEARANCE OF BHARAT'S ESSENCE SEEMED TO SRI AUROBINDO TO BE ONE OF THE PRINCIPAL CHALLENGES TO INDIA'S FREEDOM

For them, an anthem qualifies only when it incites violence, destruction and clash. Freedom for the "woke" is not sacred; it is not necessary. In its spree of deconstruction, the "woke" will not hesitate to barter freedom.

The "woke" has internalised a non-Indian cultural and political ideology and framework. The "woke's" agenda is to force that ideology into Indian structures and conditions. It does not, therefore, see India's political, economic, cultural and intellectual freedom as sacrosanct. The "woke" opposes India's quest for "Swaraj in Ideas."

It opposes all those who, in the past and the present, speak up for the need to recover this swaraj in our thinking and expressions. The "woke" opposes Rishi Bankim, it negates Sri Aurobindo, is intolerant of Vivekananda, is selective of Ambedkar and has no time for the revolutionary nationalists who struggled to free India. The "woke" opposes Modi when he speaks of "Panch Pran", the "Five Pledges" – of the need for taking pride in our rich heritage and legacy, of erasing all traces of servitude, of forsaking the colonial mindset and of fulfilling duties and responsibilities.

Since the "woke" believes in fragmenting the nation, in erasing civilisational identities and foundations, its advocates oppose all those who speak otherwise. For them, the belief in India's rise is an illusion. India, for them, is non-existent; it is an imagination, a shallow poetic emotion, a construct with no real sense and existence. They treat as a lunatic anyone who has gone to the gallows with the hope of freeing India. They will cry hoarse against Sri Aurobindo when he says that India "is not a piece of earth, nor a figure of speech, nor a fiction of the mind"; she is a "Shakti", "Bhawani Bharati", a "living unity of the Shaktis" of the crore of people who make up the nation.

In his last address to the Constituent Assembly on 25 November 1949, Babasaheb Ambedkar was concerned with India's independence. "Will she maintain her independence, or will she lose it again?" Babasaheb made a thought-provoking point. "It is not that India was never an independent country. The point is that she once lost the independence she had. Will she lose it a second time? What perturbs me greatly is the fact that not only India has once before lost her independence, but she lost it by the infidelity and treachery of some of her own people..."

The advocates of the "woke" mentality and ideology are the treacherous infidels today. It is only the spirit of "Bharata Bhagya Vidhata" that can counter them. That spirit needs to be ceaselessly invoked and propitiated for freedom to be preserved and protected.

Views expressed are personal

Building India at 80

This I-Day marks the beginning of the next critical phase for India's growth en route to becoming a developed nation

AT VANTAGE

SHUTAPA PAUL

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND MEDIA ENTREPRENEUR

The next phase demands patriots who build rather than proclaim

Free India turns octogenarian. 80 years is a long time in a nation's journey. Ours is a historic tale of riches to rags; of exploitation and famines, of divisive politics and religious wars. And yet through the blood, and often in spite of it, the spirit of India has endured. We are no longer a curious toddler or reckless teenager; youth has made way for maturity, and the world has clocked both our vulnerabilities and potential. Today, India is a force to reckon with, and as we start the next phase of our nation's journey in an exceedingly uncertain world, India remains one of the last stable bastions in the world, both economically and culturally.

The next two decades will be make-or-break. The world is changing, technology is more disruptive than ever before, and new dangers abound. India's democratic values remain core to this next phase. It's what kept us afloat; it's been our identity in the post-colonial world; safeguarding it will ensure that we maintain predictability both in policy and governance. We have set ambitious goals for the nation; our development and infrastructure programmes have a paved path to follow, etched with several key milestones that must be achieved in the interim.

Viksit Bharat@2047 envisions a developed nation by the time we hit a century of Independence, but its fruition will depend on several other factors. We have to become the third largest global economy by 2030 (we are currently 6th trailing behind US, China, Germany, Japan, and the UK). We aim to raise manufacturing output to 25 per cent of our GDP (gross domestic product); a goal that we have struggled to meet till now. Our export targets of USD 2 trillion are being met by global uncertainties and tariff-loving ogres like Donald Trump. The manufacturing sector, particularly MSME (micro, small, and medium enterprise), is baying for enhanced institutional credit, support with certification and testing, and more opportunities to tap global markets.

> VIKSIT BHARAT@2047 ENVISIONS A DEVELOPED NATION BY THE TIME WE HIT A CENTURY OF INDEPENDENCE, BUT ITS FRUITION WILL DEPEND ON SEVERAL OTHER FACTORS

As climate change and global warming continue to wreak havoc, our sustainability goals deserve to be centre-stage in the next couple of decades. India hopes to be energy-independent by 2047 following a series of strategic accomplishments such as building 500 GW of fossil fuel-free electricity capacity, converting 30 per cent of the nation's total vehicular fleet to EVs (electric vehicles), and turning behemoths like the Indian Railways completely green by 2030. Becoming net-zero would reap rich benefits for our cities and inhabitants that are suffocating in toxic air. These ambitious plans, while welcome, must be tread upon carefully. Alternative fuels cannot come at the cost of increasing wastage of precious resources or bring with them threats of food insecurity. Development and sustainability must go hand-in-hand, working closely, with each action interwoven into the others.

On the health front, we intend to be free of malaria, lymphatic filariasis, HIV/AIDs, and sickle cell anemia. A nation en route to the developed status cannot bypass clean air and potable water; both must be easily available and accessible to all. We must plan with precision for both our young and old. India's greying population will need eldercare, healthcare, and geriatric government centres. The young, whose lives are equally facilitated and upended by technologies such as artificial intelligence, will require appropriate skill development and job opportunities.

Most importantly, in these critical 20 years, we need a new generation of patriots – those that can take us to the next level; those who build for the nation. A feverish passion must run through our veins – not blind patriotism or rose-hued nationalism that is soothed by only singing national songs and trolling on Twitter (X), but the kind that actually lights the fire in our belly to work for a nation that's on the cusp of economic greatness. We need an honest understanding and assessment of our strengths and weaknesses – a kind of SWOT (strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, threats) analysis that is brutal in its critique, optimistic in identifying opportunity, and proactive in implementing solutions. These patriots will build in India with equitability, inclusivity, and atmanirbharta (self-reliance), for Bharat and the world.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Second passenger train derails in England in 2 days

LONDON: A passenger train derailed near London on Friday, British Transport Police said, the second derailment in two days after two people were seriously injured when another train came off the tracks on Thursday.

Police said officers, paramedics and firefighters were at the scene near Wickford train station in Essex, about 30 miles east of London (48 kilometres), after receiving reports that the rear carriages of a train derailed. The carriages were in an "upright position," police said.

France's top court blocks under-15 social media ban

PARIS: A top court in France on Friday struck down a law banning children under 15 from using social media, saying it infringes on fundamental freedoms.

The Constitutional Council ruled that provisions in the ban "disproportionately infringe freedom of expression and communication" and haven't provided legal guarantees to ensure those rights, according to a press release summarising the decision. France last month became the first country in EU to pass a blanket ban on the platforms.

US forces ready to step up combat drills in Philippines

MANILA: American special operations forces are ready to step up warfighting-readiness exercises with counterparts in the Philippines and other countries in Asia to further strengthen a security alliance and help deter a major conflict in the region, a US military official said Thursday.

Adm Frank Bradley, commander of the US Special Operations Command, is in the Philippines after a trip to South Korea. He will then head to Japan for talks with military officials. He is the latest American military top brass to visit Asian allies.

An Iraqi vendor offers a peacock at Pet Market that attracts buyers and sellers peddling birds, dogs, cats, and exotic animalson Friday AP/PTI

Russian drones kill woman, 9-year-old son in northern Ukraine

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 14

Russian jet-powered drones struck a home in northern Ukraine on Friday, killing a 29-year-old woman and her 9-year-old son, officials said.

The strike came a day after the United Nations said July was the deadliest month for Ukrainian civilians since the weeks following Moscow's all-out invasion of its neighbour more than four years ago.

At least 437 civilians were killed and 2,610 wounded last month, the UN monitoring mission in Kyiv said.

That was 70 per cent higher than in July last year and 30 per cent up on June of this year.

Overall, since Russia's invasion on Feb 24, 2022, UN human rights monitors say the war has killed at least 16,874 civilians, including 820 children, and wounded 51,273, including 3,126 children.

TWO UAE TANKERS ATTACKED WHILE TRANSITING THE STRAIT

Hormuz traffic slows further after US threatens economic pressure on Iran

ASSOCIATED PRESS
London, August 14

Transit through the Strait of Hormuz appeared to grind to a near standstill on Friday after two more ships were attacked there and the United States said it could maintain a naval blockade of Iran indefinitel, Reuters reported.

A senior Iranian source said on Wednesday that there had been no progress in talks to build on a June agreement to end the war. Since the ceasefire renewed in the June deal broke down, Iran has resumed attacks on ships it accuses of trying to transit the strait without its permission.

Meanwhile, the United Arab Emirates blamed Iran for firing drones at two tankers operated by a state-owned oil company as they sailed through the Strait of Hormuz, saying Friday that the attacks were acts of piracy.

Representational Image

The attacks caused no casualties but underlined the dangers faced by vessels moving cargo through the critical waterway that connects the Persian Gulf to the open oceans, as Iran keeps a firm grip on the passage.

Two tankers owned by Abu Dhabi's state-owned oil and gas company ADNOC were attacked Thursday evening while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, the company said. It added that the attack caused no injuries and that "the situation has been brought under control."

HIGHLIGHTS

- The attacks caused no casualties but underlined the dangers faced by vessels
- However, there were reportedly no progress in US-Iran talks

The British military's United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre said two vessels were reported to have suffered minor damage when attacked by drones while transiting the Strait of Hormuz. It did not identify them as the ADNOC ships, but it appeared to be the same incident.

The UAE's Foreign Ministry blamed the attacks on Iran and said they were a "flagrant violation" of the United Nations' principles of freedom of navigation.

"Targeting commercial shipping and using the Strait of Hormuz as a tool of economic coercion or blackmail represents acts of piracy by Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps," the Foreign Ministry said.

Europe battles record heatwave, wildfires

The historic temperatures linked to human-caused climate change

Crews clear brush above Castro Canyon as the Timber Fire burns FILE PHOTO

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Paris, August 14

Firefighters across Europe struggled against multiple fires Friday as a new wave of record-breaking heat baked a swath of the continent, their task further complicated by exceptionally parched landscapes.

The historic temperatures are linked to human-caused climate change, and are hitting countries more used to long cold seasons and ill-equipped for this sort of heat, with limited air conditioning.

With France experiencing its driest year ever, a new fire raced through woodlands overnight in the Landes region on the southwest coast.

The blaze forced more than 500 people to evacuate their homes in the town of Luglon as hundreds of firefighters deployed to the area, the regional administration said Friday.

It's one of several fires scorching forests around France this week, including in normally cooler and wetter regions in the north and Brittany.

A historic fire devoured forests near Bordeaux last month and pushed a quarter of a million people from their homes.

WITH FRANCE EXPERIENCING ITS DRIEST YEAR EVER, A NEW FIRE RACED THROUGH WOODLANDS OVERNIGHT IN THE LANDES REGION

France also has shut down six nuclear reactors in recent days because of extreme heat and drought – and because a mass of jellyfish washed up outside one power plant on the English Channel coast, utility company EDF said.

Large numbers of jellyfish are appearing on many French beaches in connection with unusually warm sea temperatures.

In a statement, the company said the shutdowns had minimal impact on France's electricity production. It said extreme weather poses no safety risks to the reactors themselves.

In the central English town of Stourbridge, where a huge blaze started Thursday, TV footage showed the fires consuming houses, with many left without roofs as flames burned inside the charred walls.

बिहार सरकार

प्राचार्य का कार्यालय, नालन्दा मेडिकल कालेज, पटना

निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

भारतीय चिकित्सा पर्षद,नई दिल्ली के मापदण्डों के अनुसार वित्तीय वर्ष 2026–27 में नालन्दा मेडिकल कालेज,पटना विभिन्न विभागों के लिये रसायन एवं ग्लासवेयर का क्रय हेतु निबंधित फर्म/निर्माता/आपूर्तिकर्त्ता/प्राधिकृत बिक्रेता से मुहरबन्द निविदा सील्ड लिफाफे राष्ट्रीय समाचार पत्र में प्रथम प्रकाशन की तिथि 21 (इक्कीस) दिनों के अन्दर निबंधित/स्पीडपोस्ट के माध्यम से कार्याबधि 10.00 बजे पूर्वाहन से सॉय 05.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। विलम्ब से प्राप्त निविदा पर विचार नही किया जायगा। निविदा दो तरह की होगी। (क) तकनिकी निविदा (ख) वित्तीय निविदा । दोनो निविदा अलग–अलग लिफाफे में सील्ड कर पुनः उसे वडे लिफाफे में सील्ड कर उस पर किस मद के लिये निविदा दिया जा रहा है अंकित कर प्राचार्य,नालन्दा मेडिकल कालेज,पटना–26 को भेजना होगा।निविदा टंकित/कम्पयुटराईज होना चाहिए। काट–कुट लिप्त लेखन वाले निविदा पर विचार नही किया जायगा। निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि की अगली तिथि को अपराहन 1.00 बजे निविदा क्रय समिति द्वारा खोली जायगी। उक्त तिथि को अवकाश की स्थिति में अगले कार्य दिवस को निविदा खोली जायगी। निविदा खुलने के समय निविदादाता स्वंय या उनके अधिकृत प्रतिनिधि उपस्थित रह सकते हैं।निविदा की विवरणी एवं शर्ते तथा क्रय की जाने वाली रसायन एवं ग्लासवेयर की सूची nmchpatna.ac.in से डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है। निविदा की

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखें अथवा कार्यालय से सम्पर्क करें।

प्राचार्य
नालन्दा मेडिकल कालेज,पटना

PR. No. 009900 (Health) 2026-27

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सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

On I-Day, Pakistan's top leadership calls for national unity and peace

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Islamabad, August 14

Pakistan's top civil and military leadership on Friday called for national unity, peace and economic progress as the country celebrated its 80th Independence Day. In his Independence Day message, Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif said Pakistan desired peace but would never allow that desire to be mistaken for weakness.

"We do not want war; we want peace. But the desire for peace should not be taken as weakness," he said.

Recalling last year's four-day conflict with India, Sharif said Pakistan remained committed to defending its national interests, including its right to water resources, and reiterated that it would continue to play its role as a responsible nation and a stabilising force for regional and global peace.

A man rides his motorcycle mounted with model fighter jets and missiles during Independence Day celebrations in Lahore AP/PTI

On May 7, 2025, India launched Operation Sindoor, targeting terror infrastructure in Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Kashmir in retaliation for the Pahalgam attack that killed 26 civilians. India and Pakistan reached an understanding to end the conflict after four days of intense cross-border drone and missile strikes.

In his address, Sharif also accused India of "unilaterally and illegally suspending" the Indus Waters Treaty. "I declare in clear words that every single drop of Pakistan's water is our red line," he said.

New Delhi suspended the treaty last year as one of the punitive measures against Islamabad after the Pahalgam terror attack.

महाराष्ट्र शासन

जिल्हाधिकारी कार्यालय, लातूर

(महसूल विभाग)

जा.क्र.2026/महसूल/टंपाई/ई-निविदा/कावि-165 दिनांक:- 14/08/2026

ई-निविदा प्रसिध्दीसाठी सुचना

जिल्हाधिकारी कार्यालय, लातूर

लातूर जिल्हयातील शहरी व ग्रामीण भागात टंचाईवस्त गावांना, वाड्यांना खाजगी टँकर/ट्रक्सव्दारे पिण्याच्या पाण्याचा पुरवठा करणेसाठी कंत्राटदाराकडुन ई-निविदा मागविण्यात येत आहेत.

उपरोक्त ई-निविदा बाबत फॉर्मची विक्री, स्विकृती व निविदा उघडण्याची कार्यवाही पुढीलप्रमाणे राहील.

अ.क्र.	खाजगी टँकर/ट्रक पुरवठा कंत्राटदारासाठीची ई-निविदा	कालावधी	
		दिनांक	वेळ
1	निविदा प्रसिध्दी	19/08/2026	
2	निविदा स्विकृती सुरुवात	19/08/2026	सकाळी 11.00 वा.
3	निविदा स्विकृती अंतिम	09/09/2026	सायं. 05.00 वा.
4	तांत्रिक निविदा उघडणे	10/09/2026	सायं. 05.00 वा.
5	आर्थिक निविदा उघडणे	तांत्रिक निविदा पात्र ठरल्यानंतर उघडण्यात येईल.	

निविदा फॉर्मी विक्री व स्विकृतीची कार्यवाही वरील कालावधीत https://www.mahatenders.gov.in या संकेतस्थळावर करण्यात येईल. तसेच सविस्तर निविदा सुचना उपरोक्त संकेतस्थळावर आणि https://www.latur.gov.in या संकेतस्थळावर उपलब्ध आहे. अधिक माहितीसाठी जिल्हाधिकारी कार्यालय, लातूर यांचे दुरध्वनी क्रमांक (02382) 223234 वर संपर्क साधावा.

Dgipr/2026-27/2312

डॉ. भारत वास्टेवाई (भा.प्र.से)
जिल्हाधिकारी, लातूर

Afghans get safer streets but pleas for jobs, education

Afghanistan marks five years under Taliban rule

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kabul, August 14

As Afghanistan's Taliban rulers mark five years since sweeping back to power, some Kabul residents said they feel safer after decades of conflict and upheaval but stressed the leaders should now focus on creating jobs and expanding access to schools in the country where girls above the age of 12 are banned from education.

"Thank God, the past five years have passed in safety," said Mohammad Qasim, 30, reflecting on the anniversary that comes against a backdrop of economic hardship in a conflict-stricken country. "Our wish and hope from the government is to create job opportunities for the youth."

"We, along with the entire nation, call upon the government to create employment opportunities for the youth and to encourage them to pursue education," he added.

The Taliban regained control of Afghanistan on Aug. 15, 2021, after it launched an offensive as the US and other NATO troops withdrew from the country after two decades of war. The withdrawal led to chaotic scenes at and around Kabul's airport with thousands wanting to leave.

KEY POINTS

- Taliban curbs women's rights despite pledge
- The Taliban regained control of Afghanistan on August 15, 2021, after it launched an offensive

The group initially pledged to protect women's rights but soon banned girls and women from attending secondary school and higher education, citing its interpretations of Islamic laws. It later also imposed restrictions on women's employment and travelling without a male guardian.

While the UN has acknowledged that the country has become more stable since the takeover, it has warned that lasting stability cannot be possible unless the Taliban rulers -- who remain isolated internationally -- lift restrictions on women and girls, protect basic rights and address terrorism concerns.

"A reduction in conflict has brought tangible benefits for many Afghans and created opportunities to focus on recovery, development and regional economic cooperation," the United Nations Assistance Mission in Afghanistan, or UNAMA, said in a statement ahead of the anniversary.

Reliance and Rolls-Royce partner to develop indigenous engine for AMCA

The two companies, in a joint statement, said they would explore forming a dedicated Aerospace Gas Turbine Complex in India

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

Reliance Industries and Rolls-Royce on Friday said they intend to jointly develop a sovereign combat engine for the Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (AMCA) programme, marking a bid by India's largest private-sector company and Britain's storied aero-engine maker to build indigenous fighter-jet propulsion capability in the country.

The two companies, in a joint statement, said they would explore forming a dedicated Aerospace Gas Turbine Complex in India, envisioned as a centre of excellence for power and propulsion technology, covering design, development, manufacturing, testing, production and through-life support of combat engines.

The proposed partnership would combine Britain's storied aero-engine maker's technology and expertise with Reliance's technology, manufacturing and execution capabilities to develop the AMCA engine in India.

KEY POINTS

- **'India's strategic autonomy requires sovereign capability in critical technologies,' Reliance Industries executive director Anant Ambani said in the statement**
- **'The venture could also open the door to broader collaboration in defence, & civil aerospace, beyond AMCA engine itself'**

The announcement frames the tie-up as advancing Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi's push for the country's defence sector to produce an indigenous engine to power its fighter jet programme, part of the broader "Atmanirbhar Bharat", or self-reliant India, initiative.

"India's strategic autonomy requires sovereign capability in critical technologies," Anant Ambani, executive director of Reliance Industries, said in the statement. He said the partnership would combine Rolls-Royce's propulsion expertise with Reliance's "technology, manufacturing, scale and execution capabilities" to build an aero-engine ecosystem in India that could become "self-reliant and, over time, globally competitive".

Current account deficit widens to $6.2 billion in June: RBI data

The CAD was primarily driven by widening trade deficit, which rose to $30.2 billion in June 2026

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 14

India's current account deficit (CAD) widened to $6.2 billion in June from a surplus of $1.2 billion in the year-ago month, according to preliminary data released by the Reserve Bank of India on Friday.

The current account deficit was primarily driven by a widening merchandise trade deficit, which rose to $30.2 billion in June 2026 from $19.2 billion a year earlier.

Merchandise exports increased to $41.2 billion in June from $35.3 billion in the year-ago month, while imports rose at a faster pace to $71.4 billion from $54.5 billion.

The data from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) also showed that the surplus in services increased to $17.9 billion in June 2026 from $16.2 billion a year earlier.

Services exports rose to $36.4 billion from $32.1 billion, while imports increased to $18.5 billion from $15.9 billion.

Net transfers also rose to $11.9 billion in June from $10.9 billion, while net income deficit narrowed to $5.8 billion from $6.8 billion. On the capital account front, net inflows stood at $9.1 billion in June 2026, compared with an outflow of $1.6 billion in the year-ago month.

Net foreign direct investment stood at $1.3 billion in June, while foreign portfolio investment recorded a net inflow of $2.5 billion.

The overall balance was positive at $2.9 billion in June 2026, against a deficit of $0.4 billion in June 2025.

During the April-June quarter, the merchandise trade deficit widened to $85.7 billion from $68.9 billion, while the services surplus increased to $52.2 billion from $47.9 billion.

Net transfers rose to $41.4 billion during April-June 2026 from $30.9 billion in the year-ago period.

The overall balance during the quarter was negative at $8.1 billion compared with a positive $4.5 billion in April-June 2025, the RBI data showed.

NMDC Q1 profit rises to ₹2,005.71 crore

Total income of company increased 1.5 per cent to Rs 7,142.54 crore

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

State-owned NMDC Limited on Friday reported a 2 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 2,005.71 crore for the June quarter of FY27, from Rs 1,967.46 crore a year ago.

Total income increased 1.5 per cent to Rs 7,142.54 crore, while revenue from iron ore sales rose nearly 10 per cent to Rs 6,802.12 crore.

NMDC Chairman & MD Amitava Mukherjee

The company produced 15.12 million tonnes (MT) of iron ore during the quarter, up 26 per cent year-on-year, while sales rose 2 per cent to 11.73 million tonnes.

The company said it has paid Rs 639.61 crore towards 2,857.54 acres of land in Karnataka for its proposed 3 MTPA integrated steel plant through subsidiary Karnataka Vijayanagar Steel Limited.

The land is in the subsidiary's possession, though the lease agreement is yet to be executed.

NMDC Chairman & Managing Director Amitava Mukherjee said the company is targeting 60 million tonnes production in FY27 and 100 million tonnes by 2030, focusing on higher volumes and productivity.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

HUDCO organised a Har Ghar Tiranga celebration at India Habitat Centre, New Delhi, where Union Minister Manohar Lal inaugurated the campaign kiosk in the presence of HUDCO CMD Sanjay Kulshrestha, IHC Director Prof K G Suresh, TERI DG Dr Vibha Dhawan and schoolchildren.

J&K Bank Zonal Head Srinagar Sheikh Mohammad Muzaffar, along with PNB MetLife Associate Director & Relationship Head Irfan Ali Zargar, hands over a symbolic Rs 2.55 cr life insurance claim-settlement cheque to Residency Road Branch Head Tajamul Qadri, in the presence of Project Head Sheikh Yasir Arafat, Regional Manager Sajid Ali Khan & Zonal Insurance Coordinator Tahseena.

KIRTI CHAKRA
1. LT COL MANEO FRANCIS PF, SC, 21 PARA (SF)
2. MAJ JITENDRA RATHEE, 2 PARA (SF)
3. HAV GAJENDRA SINGH, 2 PARA (SF) (POSTHUMOUS)

BAR TO SHAURYA CHAKRA
1. MAJ ADITYA PRATAP SINGH, SC, SM, RAJ RIF, 44 ASSAM RIF

SHAURYA CHAKRA
1. MAJ PARAMVEER, GARH RIF, 36 RR
2. MAJ TARUN VASUDEVAN, ENGRS, 57 RR
3. MAJ KESHAV KUMAR, 12 DOGRA
4. MAJ GAURAV SINGH BRIJWAL, 21 GRENADIERS
5. MAJ VIPEEN KUMAR, SIGS, 11 RR
6. NB SUB SHANKAR RAM, 3 ASSAM RIF
7. NB SUB DABBAL SINGH BISHT, 21 PARA (SF)
8. HAV JAGATTAR SINGH, 4 PARA (SF)
9. L/NK NARENDER SINDHU, RAJ RIF, 9 RR (POSTHUMOUS)
10. L/NK KAPIL DEV, DOGRA, 11 RR
11. SEP JASWINDER SINGH, 7 SIKH LI

BAR TO SENA MEDAL (GALLANTRY)
1. MAJ DS PAOSHO, SM, 7 MADRAS
2. MAJ ANUJ MAHAJAN, SM, MECH INF, 36 ASSAM RIF
3. MAJ KRISHAN KANT, SM, 21 PARA (SF)
4. SUB RAMESH KUMAR, SM, 159 INF BN (TA)
5. NB SUB RAJENDRA SINGH, SM, 2 PARA (SF)

SENA MEDAL (GALLANTRY)
1. LT COL PUSHKAR VIJAY CHAUDHARY, 27 (I) R&O FLT
2. LT COL SONAM TOPDEN BHUTIA, 2/8 GR
3. MAJ SUDHANSU SEKHAR PANI, 10 PARA (SF)
4. MAJ MOHIT PODIA, ARTY, 37 ASSAM RIF
5. MAJ R SAHIL, GARH RIF, 33 ASSAM RIF
6. MAJ BALENDU KUMAR JHA, 24 GRENADIERS
7. MAJ RAVI SHANKAR JOSHI, RAJ RIF, 57 RR
8. MAJ RUPAM DAS, 8 BIHAR
9. MAJ ARNAV BALI, MECH INF, 9 RR
10. MAJ ANSHUMAN RANJAN, 4 PARA (SF)
11. MAJ ARVIND KUMAR, ENGRS, 33 ASSAM RIF
12. CAPT KARAN SINGH CHEEMA, ASSAM, 59 RR
13. CAPT HARISH SINGH DEWALI, MARATHA LI, 17 RR
14. CAPT MOHIT RAWAT, SIGS, 44 ASSAM RIF
15. CAPT ANSHUMAAN SINGH, 11 PARA (SF)
16. CAPT BANE SWARAJ SUDHIR, 21 PARA (SF)
17. CAPT PRUTHVIRAJ JAYSING NIGHOT, 21 PARA (SF)
18. CAPT SAVIK, 5/9 GR
19. LT BHANU PRATAP SINGH, 12 DOGRA
20. LT AMAN PANDEY, 8 BIHAR
21. ASST COMDT BIKASH RAI, 11 ASSAM RIF
22. SUB PAWAN KUMAR, 11 PARA (SF)
23. SUB PERBHAT GAUR, 10 PARA (SF) (POSTHUMOUS)
24. SUB KANASE NAMDEV BALKRISHNA, 18 MARATHA LI
25. SUB BALJINDER SINGH, 7 SIKH LI
26. NB SUB DAYAL SINGH, GARH RIF, 36 RR
27. HAV L JOEL KOM, 21 PARA (SF)
28. HAV MULLA ABIDALI ASHRAFALI, 18 MARATHA LI
29. L/HAV PALASH GHOSH, 5 PARA (SF) (POSTHUMOUS)
30. NK ALI MOHAMMAD KHAN, 24 GRENADIERS
31. L/NK SUJAY GHOSH, 5 PARA (SF) (POSTHUMOUS)
32. L/NK ABHIMANU SINGH, 21 GRENADIERS
33. L/NK BIDHA SINGH, JAT, 34 RR
34. L/NK PRITPAL SINGH, SIKH LI, 19 RR (POSTHUMOUS)
35. SEP HARMINDER SINGH, SIKH LI, 19 RR (POSTHUMOUS)
36. PTR HIMANSHU KUMAR, 21 PARA (SF)

MENTION-IN-DESPATCHES

OPERATION RAKSHAK
1. COL RANVEER SINGH, 207 ARMY AVN SQN (UH)
2. LT COL ABHISHEK JOSHI, SM, 666 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
3. LT COL HIMANSHU SHARMA, 21 COUNTER INSURGENCY INT UNIT
4. LT COL ADITYA JASROTIA, 666 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
5. MAJ DEVSHREE ARVIND SHARMA, 25 MADRAS
6. MAJ KUNAL NARULA, 662 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
7. MAJ SWAPNIL SRIVASTAVA, RAJ RIF, 9 RR
8. MAJ AKSHAY SINGH, DOGRA, 11 RR
9. MAJ ARUN, ARTY, 11 RR
10. MAJ ABDULASSISS M, MECH INF, 26 RR
11. MAJ ROHIT SHARMA, 290 FD REGT
12. CAPT MUNIRAJ T, AMC, 19 RR
13. DSP SULTAN MAHMOOD, J&K POLICE
14. SUB MANOJ KUMAR, 4 PARA (SF)
15. NB SUB KARAMBIR, 21 GRENADIERS
16. HAV AIJAZ AHMED, 159 INF BN (TA)
17. NK MUKESH SINGH, 159 INF BN (TA)
18. NK ROSHAN KUMAR, ENGRS, 3 RR
19. NK RAJAT SHARMA, 12 DOGRA
20. NK NANDAN SINGH GUSAIN, 4 PARA (SF)
21. RFN RANJEET SINGH, RAJ RIF, 57 RR
22. RFN RAMESH SINGH, GARH RIF, 36 RR
23. RFN GOVIND SINGH, RAJ RIF, 57 RR
24. PTR MADHUKAR SHAILESH CHOUGULE, 2 PARA (SF)
25. ARMY DOG TYSON, RVC, 2 PARA (SF)

OPERATION SNOW LEOPARD
26. LT COL SUHEL SINGH GILL, 666 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
27. LT COL RAKESH VASHISHTH, 301 ARMY AVN SQN (SO)
28. MAJ ABHIMANYU YADAV, 16 PUNJAB
29. MAJ RAJIV MEEL, 203 ARMY AVN SQN (UH)
30. MAJ ABHISHEK ARJUN, GARH RIF, 666 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
31. MAJ RAHUL MEHTA, ARTY, HQ SFF
32. CAPT MOHIT GANJOO, ASSAM, 59 RR
33. CAPT GAURAV KUMAR, 60 ARMD REGT

OPERATION HIFAZAT
34. LT COL SOUBAM KINOBABU SINGH, SM, 2 JAK LI
35. MAJ NIKAM NIKHIL JANARDHAN, 2/8 GR
36. MAJ AMIT NAIN, 19 GARH RIF
37. MAJ ABHISHEK KUMAR SINGH, 2 JAK LI
38. MAJ VISHAL RANA, 2 JAK LI
39. MAJ C SAI VIVEK, SM, ARTY, 33 ASSAM RIF
40. MAJ ZUBAIR AHMAD ITOO, ENGRS, 19 ASSAM RIF
41. MAJ RAJKUMAR SANJEEV, JAK RIF, 31 ASSAM RIF
42. MAJ SHARMA TANUJ DILIP, 2 JAK LI
43. CAPT ARUN KUMAR SOLANIA, 2 MAHAR
44. CAPT ATHARV SHRIRANG JADHAV, 5/9 GR
45. LT SHIVAM PANDAY, 2 JAK LI
46. SUB TIL BAHADUR DANGI, 21 PARA (SF)
47. SUB AMIT KUMAR, 2 MAHAR
48. SUB JARNAIL SINGH, 2 MAHAR
49. HAV NEHKHOHAO HAOKIP, 165 INF BN (TA)
50. HAV DEVENDRA SINGH NEGI, 21 PARA (SF)
51. HAV DONGARE GULABRAO SHAMRAO, 2 MAHAR
52. NK KAPIL DEV, 21 PARA (SF)
53. NK SUNIL KUMAR, 2 MAHAR
54. L/NK BINNAR YOGESH POPAT, 21 PARA (SF)
55. L/NK JASPUNEET SINGH, 22 SIKH
56. SEP SHUBHAM KUMAR, 8 BIHAR
57. RFN BHOJ BAHADUR RANA MAGAR, 2/8 GR
58. RFN H YANG PANG SHANYEI PHOM, 22 ASSAM RIF
59. RFN DELBOR ALI MONDAL, 3 ASSAM RIF
60. RFN ADEPU RAKESH, 3 ASSAM RIF
61. PTR RAHUL KUMAR YADAV, 21 PARA (SF)
62. AGNIVEER HARIOM, 2 MAHAR
63. AGNIVEER KRISHAN KUMAR, 2 MAHAR

OPERATION ORCHID
64. MAJ DEBASHISH PUSTI, ARMD, 13 ASSAM RIF
65. MAJ LAKSHYADEEP KANKER, AAD, 4 ASSAM RIF
66. PTR BIKASH KAKATI, 11 PARA (SF)
67. PTR YOG RAJ, 11 PARA (SF)
68. PTR LALTAN SANGA, 11 PARA (SF)
69. PTR DEEPCHAND KARGWAL, SM, 21 PARA (SF)

OPERATION MEGHDOOT
70. MAJ DEVESH BHANDARI, 666 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
71. MAJ RISHIKESH PATHAK, 24 PUNJAB
72. HAV NARESH SHARMA, 18 JAK RIF

OPERATION FALCON
73. LT COL VIKAS PANDEY, 667 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)
74. MAJ KARTIK YADAV, AAD, 667 ARMY AVN SQN (R&O)

MISC OPERATION
75. LT COL ROHIT SINGH SAHI, INT (RETD)

CBC 10127/13/0002/2627

GALLANT ACTS OF OUR HEROES WILL ALWAYS BE A SOURCE OF INSPIRATION TO THE NATION

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Briefs

Gold falls to ₹1.56L/10 gm

NEW DELHI: Gold prices fell for the second day on Friday, declining Rs 800 to Rs 1,56,200 per 10 grams amid profit-booking & weak global cues. Silver, however, remained unchanged at Rs 2,40,000 per kg.

In the global markets, spot gold was trading marginally lower to $4,351.01 per ounce while silver went rose 0.33 per cent to $64.68 per ounce.

Rupee rises 3 paise to 95.42/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee appreciated 3 paise to close at 95.42 against the US dollar on Friday, due to weakness in the greenback.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.39 and moved in a tight range of 95.38 to 95.44 against the American currency before ending the session at 95.42, up 3 paise from its previous close.

Meanwhile, the dollar index was trading 0.08 per cent lower at 99.78.

THE RETAIL INFLATION ROSE TO 4.45% IN JULY

WPI-based inflation eases to 9.78% in July on softening in fuel prices

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

Wholesale price inflation softened month-on-month for the first time in nine months to 9.78 per cent in July on easing in fuel and food prices.

Wholesale price index (WPI)-based inflation was 9.87 per cent in June.

This is the first time since October 2025 that WPI inflation has fallen month-on-month. The softening in July numbers is mainly on account of lower inflation in fuel & power even as inflation in primary articles and manufactured products accelerated.

"Across groups, mineral oils (containing petroleum products), food articles, manufacture of basic metals, non-food articles, manufacture of food products, and manufacture of chemicals and chemical products have been major drivers of WPI inflation in July 2026," the commerce and industry ministry said while releasing the monthly Wholesale Price Index (WPI) data on Friday.

Wholesale inflation in fuel and power dropped to 20.05 per cent in July, as against 27.41 per cent in June.

Inflation in food articles too eased marginally to 5.44 per cent in July from 5.49 per cent in June.

However, manufactured products saw an uptick in inflation at 8.29 per cent in July, as against 7.48 per cent in June.

As per the data, the output Producer Price Index (PPI) - which the government has said will eventually replace the WPI in about 5 years – remained unchanged at 9.6 per cent YoY in July vis-a-vis June.

Output PPI saw lower inflation in manufacturing and mining, but higher agriculture and electricity PPI nullified those gains.

In a research note, Barclays said the direction of the WPI has reversed and WPI inflation should soften in coming months as global prices seem to have peaked.

"In our view, WPI inflation has peaked and gradual and modest disinflation from hereon should continue, in line with relatively lower global commodity prices in general and crude oil price in particular (since June)," Barclays said.

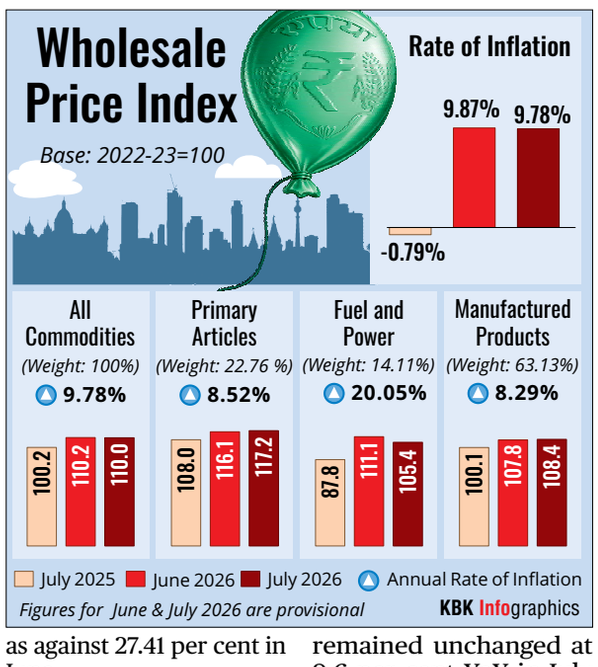
The war in West Asia war which began on February 28 and the resultant blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, through which the majority of crude oil is imported into India, has kept WPI elevated with pressure on global crude and fertiliser costs.

ICRA Principal Economist Rahul Agrawal said the moderation in July WPI was not broad-based and was entirely led by the fuel and power group whereas all the other groups witnessed a hardening in their inflation prints vis-a-vis June 2026.

"Looking ahead, we anticipate a larger easing in the WPI inflation to below 9.5 per cent in August, after peaking at 9.9 per cent each during May-June 2026. Nevertheless, prints are likely to remain elevated through much of the year, with an average WPI inflation forecast of around 8.5 per cent for FY27," Agrawal said.

The WPI data is in contrast to the retail inflation numbers released earlier this week. The consumer price index based retail inflation rose to 4.45 per cent in July from 4.38 per cent in June, on high food prices.

The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Monetary Policy Committee, earlier this month, kept benchmark policy rates unchanged at 5.25 per cent and has projected retail inflation at 5 per cent for FY2026-27.



KEY POINTS

- This is the first time since October 2025 that WPI inflation has fallen month-on-month
- The softening in July numbers is mainly on account of lower inflation in fuel & power even as inflation in primary articles and manufactured products accelerated
- As per the data, the output Producer Price Index (PPI) - which the government has said will eventually replace the WPI in about 5 years — remained unchanged at 9.6 per cent YoY in July vis-a-vis June

India's exports to FTA partners gain pace in June quarter

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

India's exports to key free trade agreement (FTA) partner countries witnessed strong growth in the first quarter of 2026-27, with outbound shipments to Singapore and Sri Lanka more than doubling, according to the commerce ministry data.

India has so far signed 17 FTAs with a number of countries and groups, including Singapore, Malaysia, South Korea, Mauritius, the UAE, Australia, the European Union, Asean and the EFTA bloc. Out of this, 16 are operational.

The data showed that exports to Singapore surged 101.2 per cent to $6.52 billion during April-June 2026, from $3.24 billion in the year-ago period, while shipments to Sri Lanka rose 123.8 per cent to $2.35 billion from $1.05 billion.

The shipments to the ASEAN (Association of South East Asian Nations) region grew 61.6 per cent to $14.61 billion in the first quarter of this fiscal, from $9.04 billion in April-June 2025-26.

Exports to the South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) region rose 36.6 per cent to $8.40 billion from $6.15 billion. Among individual countries, Malaysia recorded a 75.2 per cent increase in the outbound shipments to $2.54 billion, while shipments to Australia grew 25.2 per cent to $2.68 billion during April-June 2026-27.

Exports to the UK rose 11.1 per cent to $3.69 billion during the quarter from $3.32 billion in the year-ago period. The India-UK trade agreement was operationalised from July 15, 2026.

Shipments to South Korea rose by 22.6 per cent to $1.95 billion, while to Japan, they grew 22.4 per cent to $1.75 billion.

India's exports to Oman grew 26.4 per cent to $1.39 billion, while shipments to Nepal rose 18.1 per cent to $2.28 billion.

Exports to Bhutan and Thailand increased 16.1 per cent and 6 per cent, respectively, to $360 million and $1.23 billion during the period.

The data indicates that across key FTA partner countries, India's exports are growing robustly, an official said. The sharp increase in the shipments contributed significantly to the overall momentum in exports during the quarter.

During April-June this fiscal, the country's total exports increased 15.92 per cent to $129.32 billion.

India records ₹7.73 lakh cr exports in fiscal 2026 under STP scheme

ANI NEWS
Mumbai, August 14

India's Software Technology Park (STP) units recorded estimated exports of over Rs 7.73 lakh crore in FY26, registering a 21.56 per cent increase from Rs 6.36 lakh crore in FY24, according to data shared by the Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY). The data showed that exports by STP units stood at Rs 7,73,898.97 (estimated) crore in FY26 against Rs 6,36,619.87 crore in FY24.

The Software Technology Park (STP) Scheme is a key government initiative to expand India's IT sector and promote software and IT-enabled services (IT/ITeS) exports.

"STP Scheme is a 100% export-oriented scheme to promote software and IT-enabled services (IT/ITeS) exports from India and STPI has been providing Statutory Services on a single-window Clearance System under STP Scheme," the release said.

As per export-import data shared by the Ministry, India's exports from STP units rose 21.57 per cent, from Rs 6,36,619.87 crore in FY24 to Rs 7,73,898.97 crore in FY26. Notably, exports increased consistently from Rs 6,36,619.87 crore in FY24 to Rs 6,88,194.11 crore in FY 2024-25 and further to Rs 7,73,898.97 crore in FY26.

However total investment reported by STP units declined from Rs 10,709.92 crore in FY24 to Rs 8,870.78 crore in FY25 and further to Rs 7,362.86 crore in FY26.

At the same time, imports by STP units stood at Rs 9,947.47 crore in FY24, Rs 9,482.27 crore in FY 25 and Rs 9,960.26 crore in FY26.

Stock markets end lower amid elevated oil prices and geopolitical uncertainty

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 14

Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower on Friday as elevated oil prices and the prolonged US-Iran impasse weighed on investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 70.71 points, or 0.09 per cent, to settle at 78,009.25. The 50-share NSE Nifty dipped 29.85 points, or 0.12 per cent, to end at 24,366.

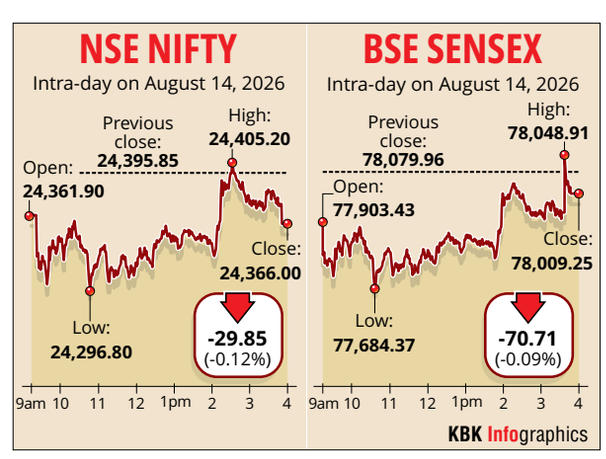
From the Sensex pack, Asian Paints, InterGlobe Aviation, NTPC, Power Grid, State Bank of India and HCL Tech were among the major laggards.

Bharti Airtel, Adani Ports, ICICI Bank and Titan were among the winners.

The BSE SmallCap Select index declined 0.65 per cent and the MidCap Select index dipped 0.13 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, Housing Finance declined 1.40 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 0.58 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks 0.46 per cent, Oil & Gas 0.45 per cent, Energy 0.44 per cent and Services 0.39 per cent.

Hospitals jumped 1.49 per cent, Telecom climbed 0.86 per cent, Insurance 0.21 per cent and Consumer Durables 0.17 per cent. FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 510.69 crore on Thursday, according to exchange data.



Forex kitty rises $14.136 billion to $707 billion

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 14

India's forex reserves jumped $14.136 billion to $707.002 billion during the week ended August 7, the RBI said on Friday.

The overall kitty had jumped by $10.512 billion to $692.866 billion in the previous reporting week ended July 31.

For the week ended August 7, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, increased $9.946 billion to $574.625 billion, the central bank's data showed.

Expressed in dollar terms, the foreign currency assets include effects of appreciation or depreciation of non-US units, such as the euro, pound, and yen, held in foreign exchange reserves.

Value of gold reserves increased $3.995 billion to $108.738 billion during the week, the RBI said.

The special drawing rights (SDRs) were up $79 million at $18.745 billion, the apex bank said.

India's reserve position with the IMF was also up by $116 million to $4.894 billion at the end of the reporting week, according to the apex bank's data.

Hindustan Zinc boosts women's economic independence across rural, industrial India

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 14

As India marks its 80th Independence Day, Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) is promoting women's economic independence through rural entrepreneurship and technology-driven roles in modern manufacturing.

Its Sakhi initiative has connected more than 25,000 rural women through Self-Help Groups, providing access to savings, credit and entrepreneurial training.

Farzana, a production associate with Sakhi Utpadan Samiti, moved from informal domestic work to earning around Rs 3.47 lakh annually through textile and FMCG production.

Through its Samadhan initiative, HZL supports women in agriculture and livestock-based livelihoods. Prem Bai Vyas of Matoon village has expanded her dairy enterprise from 10 litres of milk daily to around 85 litres, earning over Rs 90,000 a month.

Women constitute 26.3 per cent of HZL's workforce, the highest in India's metals and mining sector, the company said. They work in underground mining, heavy equipment operations, mine rescue and technology-intensive areas including artificial intelligence, automation and digitalisation.

Under Tejaswini, all-women teams manage operations at the Chanderiya Smelting Complex. At Zinc Smelter Debari, IIT Delhi graduate Swapnil Thori leads AI and machine learning-led transformation across smelters and power plants.

FinMin warns against high turnover and payroll criteria in GeM tenders

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 14

The Finance Ministry has advised central government entities against prescribing excessively high turnover and payroll requirements while procuring consultancy services through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM), saying such criteria could restrict competition.

In an office memorandum, the Department of Expenditure said minimum staff requirements should be commensurate with manpower needed to execute the consultancy assignment.

A sample study of consultancy tenders floated on GeM over the past three financial years found instances of high turnover requirements, greater weightage to firms' experience over key personnel qualifications, and payroll requirements exceeding actual project needs.

The department said such eligibility criteria may unduly restrict competition and advised procuring entities to follow the Manual for Procurement of Consultancy Services, Second Edition, 2025, while framing tender conditions. The July 22 memorandum was issued to secretaries of all Central government ministries and departments.

WBSEDCL, REC hold vendor meet under PM-Surya Ghar

Meeting held with the aim of boosting rooftop solar installations across West Bengal

MPOST BUREAU
Kolkata, August 14

A National Vendor Meet under the PM-Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSGY) was jointly conducted by West Bengal State Electricity Distribution Company Limited (WBSEDCL) and REC Ltd on August 13, 2026, at Hotel Taj Bengal, New Alipore, Kolkata, with an aim to strengthen the implementation of the scheme and accelerate rooftop solar installations across West Bengal.

The meeting was Chaired by Santanu Basu, IAS, Principal Secretary, Power Department, Government of West Bengal. Officials from REC Ltd, CESC, the Government of West Bengal, State and National Vendors, and Training Partners also participated in the meeting.

Addressing the gathering, the Principal Secretary, Power Department, Government of West Bengal, emphasised that the implementation of PMSG:MBY in the state would be further strengthened through the active participation and coordinated efforts of both State and National Vendors.

He affirmed the collective commitment of the Government of West Bengal, REC Limited, WBSEDCL, Vendors, DISCOMs, financial institutions and other stakeholders towards accelerating rooftop solar adoption and strengthening the implementation of PM-Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana in West Bengal.

REC Ltd (PMSG:MBY team) headed by Smt. S. Jayanthi, ED presented the perspective of the scheme as Nodal Agency for implementation of PMSG:MBY. She urged National Vendors to deploy adequate manpower and requested Brand Owners to expand their channel partner network across West Bengal to facilitate faster installation of rooftop solar systems. She assured the stakeholders that REC, as the Nodal Agency for the implementation of PMSG:MBY, would extend all necessary support to expedite rooftop solar installations in the state, including addressing the issues faced by vendors, consumers and DISCOMs.

Also, during the meeting, Devinder, DGM REC and Raman Garg, DGM, REC delivered a presentation focused on increasing vendor participation, ensuring the quality of RTS plants, vendor rating and also outlined the provisions of training & capacity building for vendors under PMSGY in West Bengal.

Cochin Shipyard Q1 net profit declines 19.36% to ₹151.45 crore

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 14

State-owned Cochin Shipyard on Friday reported a 19.36 per cent decline in consolidated net profit to Rs 151.45 crore for the June quarter due to lower revenue across both shipbuilding and ship-repair segments.

It had clocked Rs 187.82 crore profit in the year-ago period, the company said in a regulatory filing.

The company's total income rose to Rs 1,161.25 crore in the reported quarter, from Rs 1,122.92 crore in the April-June quarter of FY26.

Cochin Shipyard's total expenses rose to Rs 958.76 crore in the June quarter of this fiscal, from Rs 873 crore in the same period a year ago.

Cochin Shipyard is one of the leading shipbuilding and repair yards in India. It also has an exclusive area set for offshore construction and future expansion.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.I.T. No.	**NIT No.11(A,B,C,D,E,F)/26-27/WE**
Name of work with its location	(A) Repair and improvement of vacant quarters in the section of SSE/W/SSB under ADEN/E-IV. (B) Repair and improvement of vacant quarters in the section of SSE/W/PB under ADEN/E-IV. (C) Repair to Unpopular/Newly Alloted qtrs. in the section of SSE/W/DKZ-I under ADEN/E-IV. (D) Repair to Outlived sewage/drainage system & replacement of old rusted water supply pipe line in block no. 1 to 14, 42 to 44 at DKZ-I Railway colony in the section of SSE/W/DKZ-I under ADEN/E-IV. (E) Repair to Unpopular/Newly Alloted qtrs. at DKZ-II railway, colony under ADEN/E-IV. (F) Improvement of firefighting system, addressable alarm system, PA system provision of fire sprinkler system in record room and DAO building as per instruction of Delhi Fire Service for annual maintenance contract of fire fighting system for 36 month at DAO building in the s/o SSE/W/T, Camp. And Operation & maintenance of Fire Fighting system at ORH Abhinandan for 36 month at TKJ in the section of SSE/W/MNTB under ADEN/E-I.

Approx. Cost of work	**(A)** ₹11999928.54	**(B)** ₹7999856.78	**(C)** ₹8999625.13
	(D) ₹8999901.61	**(E)** ₹8999892.70	**(F)** ₹31528496.68
EMD Amount	**(A)** ₹240000.00	**(B)** ₹160000.00	**(C)** ₹180000.00
	(D) ₹180000.00	**(E)** ₹180000.00	**(F)** ₹630600.00

Completion period of work	**For Sr. No. A, B, C D & E**	8 Months
	For Sr. No. F:	36 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Closing Date of Tender on 07.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.	
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in**	

No.: 128-W/269/O.E.T./NIT No. 11 (A, B, C, D, E, F)/26-27/WE/
Dated: 12.08.2026 **2805/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

CHHATTISGARH STATE RENEWABLE ENERGY DEVELOPMENT AGENCY

(Dept. of Energy, Govt. of Chhattisgarh)

VIP Road (Airport Road), Near Energy Education Park, Raipur (C.G.)
Tel.: 70002-51010 **E-mail:** credatendercell@gmail.com **Web:** www.creda.co.in

NIT Ref. No. 5997/CREDA/Solar Off-grid Inverter/2026-27 Date: 13.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

T. No. 195833 (2nd Call)

CREDA invites online Tender from the manufactures or their authorised representative/dealer/distributor for "standardization of rates for supply of solar off-grid inverter of various capacity with 05 years onsite warranty conforming to the IEC/BIS and MNRE standards anywhere in the state of Chhattisgarh" from registered vendors of CREDA (As per clause 11, page 10, section-01) having 3 years track record in the field of solar Off-grid Inverter manufacturing.

Inspection of Sample : 24.08.2026 at 3:00 PM
Last date of submission of Online Bid : 27.08.2026 till 5:00 PM
Opening of Online Bid : 31.08.2026 03:00 PM onwards

Technical Bid and Price Bid shall be submitted online only at "https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in" However Technical Bid (as per the checklist) also has to be submitted in hard copy duly signed by bidder at H.O. Tender Cell, CREDA. Bidders are advised to follow the instructions provided for Registration and e-Submission Process accordingly. (For any query about e-bidding please visit user manual at https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in.)

Tender document with all terms and conditions is available at **www.creda.co.in** and at **https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in**

CREDA reserves all rights to accept/reject any or all tenders in full/part without assigning any reasons.

samvad 48765/3 **Chief Engineer CREDA**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Aash Mohd. @ Ashu Khan, S/o. Sh. Mehruddin, R/o.: 1611, Gali No.13, Govind Puri, Kalkaji, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.249/2011 U/S 279/304A IPC** registered at **P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Aash Mohd. @ Ashu Khan** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Aash Mohd. @ Ashu Khan** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Aash Mohd. @ Ashu Khan**, accused of **FIR No.249/2011 U/S 279/304A IPC**, **P.S Alipur, Outer North District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot,
Chief Judicial Magistrate, North
Room No.115, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/11383/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS / 82 (2)(ii)Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Tosif S/o** Mohd. Siraj, R/o: Vega Bond Kabootar Market, Jama Masjid, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No. 01/2024, U/s 25/54/59 A. ACT,** Date : 01/01/2024, registered at P.S.: Jama Masjid, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Tosif** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Tosif** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Tosif** accused **FIR No. 01/2024, U/s 25/54/59 A. ACT,** registered at P.S.: Jama Masjid, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Rashi Raheja
Judicial Magistrate First Class-13
Room No. 33, Ground Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11374/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Satender @ Seetu S/o** Vijay Singh, **R/o** 123, Sanjay Ka Makan, Asha Ram Gali, Mandawali, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **MVT FIR No. 42899/2018, U/S 379 IPC, PS Mandawali, East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Satender @ Seetu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Satender @ Seetu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Satender @ Seetu** the said accused of **MVT FIR No. 42899/2018, U/S 379 IPC, PS Mandawali, East Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
Court No.-16, East Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11159/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

Municipal Council Bhind

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL
Solid Waste Management Project
Notice Inviting Request for Proposal
Tender No. 2026_UAD_528618_1

No 440 **Dated: 12.08.2026**

Online bids are hereby invited on behalf of Name of respective ULB Municipal Council Bhind eligible entities for the below mentioned work: .

Name of Work	Estimated Project Cost (In Cr)	Plant Capacity (In TPD)	Bid Security/ EMD	Performance Security	RFP Document Fee
Selection of Agency for Setting up of **Construction Of Municipal Solid Waste Processing Plant for Processing Waste in** Municipal Council Bhind	8,15,29,321/-	50 TPD	407650.00/-	(3% of the Estimated Project Cost)	Rs. 25000/-(plus applicable taxes)

1 All details relating to the bid documents can be viewd and downloaded from the website.
2 The bid document can be purchased only Online from 11 Hrs 12-8-2026 to 17:30 Hrs 11-09-2026 Other key dates may be seen in Bid Datasheet.
3 Ammendment to NIT, if any, would be published on website only and not in Newspaper.
4 For further details and e-tendering schedule, visit **mptenders.gov.in..**

Sd/-
Chief Municipal Officer
Municipal Council Bhind

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Work Tender Notice No.: 11-TMC-OS-MP-2026-27, Dated 13-08-2026

On behalf of the President of India, Dy.CE/TMC, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur, invites the following work tender:
Carrying out operation and maintenance of track machines including stipulated checks, maintenance as per the specification of RDSO/IRTMM/OEM; providing Operator (SSE(TM)/JE(TM))/Supervisors/Assistant Machine Operator (High Skilled), Track Machine Maintainers (Technicians) (Skilled) & Machine Assistant/Semi Skilled Worker/Helper as per schedule for carrying out various activities of machine including schedule maintenance and attending to the breakdowns etc. as per the instructions of Engineer in-charge at Site for a period of 02 years.
SL. No.- 1, Open tender No./due on: 11-TMC-OS-MP-2026-27 due on 04-09-2026, Description of Work: Outsourcing of Manpower Operator (SSE(TM)/JE(TM)/Supervisors/Assistant Machine Operator (Hih Skilled), Track Machine Maintainers (Technicians) (Skilled) & Machine Assistant/Semi Skilled Worker/Helper for carrying out various activities of machine including operation and maintenance and attending to the breakdowns etc., as per the instructions of Engineer incharge at Site of NER Track Machines for period of 02 years- As per NIT Schedule-A, Schedule-B & Schedule-C. Quantity Required: As per NIT Schedule, Place of work: To work on Track Machines in NER. Work Completion Period: 24 months, Estimated Tender Value (Rs.): ₹ 31,57,19,419.92, Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 63,14,400/-.
Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Service Tender is available in website on ***http://ireps.gov.in*** up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening. **(2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, venders are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with class III Digital signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **(3)** Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight way ignored and shall not be considered. **(4)** Documents being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. **(5)** Earnest Money should be deposited through online. **(6)** Tenderers quoting financial conditions deviating from tender condition stipulated in tender document are required to quantify its implications in financial term duly enclosing the calculation sheet supporting with authentic document, so that the impact of such financial condition on the offer may be worked out to decide inter-se-position of offers. In case tenderer quotes such financial condition without quantifying its financial implications, such tenders/offers shall be summarily rejected, for which Railway Administration shall not entertain any correspondence. **(7)** Tenderers are requested to read complete tender document carefully. **(8)** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached.
(1) Executive Engg./TMC: 9794840222
(2) SSE(TMC)/HQ: 9794840293

Executive Engineer/TMC,
CPRO/W-283 **Gorakhpur**

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

E-Tender notice no.: TL-AC-CRW-HRT-6
Date : 12.08.2026

For and on behalf of President of India, Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, Carriage Repair Workshop, Harnaut invites open e-tender for the following works as detailed:- **1. Name of work with its location :** Outsourcing electrical activities for work of Conversion of square type Bio- Toilets into Trapezoidal Type Bio-Toilets at CRW/HRT & different coaching depot of ECR. **2. Approx. cost of the work:** ₹ 84,35,544.00/- (Rupees Eighty-Four Lakh Thirty-Five Thousand Five Hundred Forty-Four Only/-), **3. Cost of Tender Form :** Nil, **4. Bid Security to be deposited :** ₹ 168700.00/- (Rupees One Lakh Sixty-Eight Thousand Seven Hundred Only/-), **5. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of Tender :** The tender have to be submitted online on **https://www.ireps.gov.in** website up to 12:00 hrs. on 02.09.2026 and will be opened on the same day at 12:30 hrs. **6. Website particulars, Notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.:** Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website: **https://www.ireps.gov.in** & full details of notice can be seen on notice board in the office of Chief Workshop Manager, Administrative Building, Carriage Repair Workshop, Harnaut, Nalanda, and Bihar - 803110. All corrigendum will be uploaded on website if required.

Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer
Carriage Repair Workshop/Harnaut
PR/0730/CRW-HRT/MECH/T/26-27/48

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

(Electrical (General), Construction, Egmore, Chennai)

For and on behalf of the President of India, The Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer / General / Construction / Southern Railway / Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 invites E-Tender for the following Works.

Sl. No.	Tender Notice No.	Name of the Work
1	E-HQ-CN-MS-EOT05-2026-27	PTJ/Podanur: Electrical and Power supply Arrangements for proposed Sick line Shed, Trip Shed, Store Shed, Pit lines, Service buildings, Yard, Approach Road and etc., at Podanur (PTJ) Railway Station.
2	E-HQ-CN-MS-EOT11-2026-27	PTJ/Podanur: Provision of Electrical Arrangements for construction of Staff Quarters Type II (63 units) and Type III (39 units) at Podanur (PTJ) Railway Station.
3	E-HQ-CN-MS-EOT-16-2026-27	PH-16 and PH-53: Electrical Power Supply and Lighting arrangements for 1). Proposed Goods yard (720m) and Goods PF (720m) at AJJ / Arakkonam Junction (PH-16), 2). Proposed Pitlines (2Nos), Goods PF 740m, Island PF Extension x 2Nos (100m) and Yard Lighting for Stabling Line (2 Nos) at GPD / Gummidipoondi Railway station (PH-16), 3). Utility shifting at JTJ / Jolarpettai Junction (PH-16), 4). Proposed PF with shelters (580m) at PDY / Puducherry Railway station (PH-16), 5). Proposed Pitline1 (596m), Pitline-2 (524m), Yard for 9Nos of stabling line (600m), Service buildings (300sqft), Approach road for station (100m), FOB (50m) at SO /Salt Cotaurs Railway station (PH-16), 6). Yard Lighting for 5Nos of stabling line (350m) and Utility shifting at AJJ / Arakkonam Junction (PH-16), 7). Proposed PF-1 Extension (100m), PF-2 Extension (120m) and Utility shifting at MAS Station Yard (PH-53).

Sl. No.	Period of Completion	Approximate Cost of Work	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Tender Closing Date & Time	Tender Opening Date & Time	Tender Type
1	12 Months	₹ 13,51,65,934/-	₹ 27,03,300/-	07.09.2026 & 11.00 hrs	07.09.2026 & 11.30 hrs	Two Packet
2	6 Months	₹ 2,20,11,735/-	₹ 4,40,200/-	07.09.2026 & 11.00 hrs	07.09.2026 & 11.30 hrs	Single Packet
3	18 Months	₹ 6,64,95,978/-	₹ 13,29,900/-	07.09.2026 & 11.00 hrs	07.09.2026 & 11.30 hrs	Single Packet

Complete details can be viewed on **www.ireps.gov.in**

Deputy Chief Electrical Engineer / Construction /
Chennai Egmore - 600008

POSSESSION NOTICE

GODREJ FINANCE

GODREJ FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai- 400079 Maharashtra
Branch Office: Godrej Capital, Agra- Office No. 402, 4th Floor, Corporate Park, Block No. 109, Sanjay Place, Ward Hariparwat, Agra- 282002,

Possession Notice (For Immovable Property)
(Rule 8(1) of The Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)
LOAN/FACILITY ACCOUNT NO.- GFL3204LP0093670 & GFL3204BL0098484 -
LOAN AGAINST PROPERTY & BUSINESS LOAN GRANTED
TO MR. ISHAN DHAWAN, MR. RAJEEV KUMAR DHAWAN, MRS. SANTOSH DHAVAN.

Whereas, the authorized officer of the Godrej Finance Limited, a Company incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 having registration as a Finance company from the Reserve Bank of India & having registered office at Godrej One, Pirojshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East) Mumbai-400079 Maharashtra & One of the office at Godrej Capital, Agra - Office No. 402, 4th Floor, Corporate Park, Block No. 109, Sanjay Place, Ward Hariparwat, Agra-282002, Uttar Pradesh. under The Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets And Enforcement Of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of The Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, issued a demand Notice Dated **08.06.2026** calling upon Applicant/Borrower/Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors (1) Mr. Ishan Dhawan, (2) Mr. Rajeev Kumar Dhawan, and (3) Mrs. Santosh Dhavan to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 33,19,638/- (INR Thirty Three Lakhs Nineteen Thousand Six Hundred and Thirty Eight Only)** due as on **08.06.2026** with subsequent interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. as per the agreement(s) within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
The Applicant/ Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors, having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Applicant/Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors in particular and the public in general that the undersigned authorized officer of company has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under section 13(4) of the said act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on this 12th day of August 2026.
The Applicant / Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors attention is invited to provisions of Sub- Section (8) of Section 13 of the said act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured asset/s.
The Applicant / Borrower/ Co-Applicant/Co-Borrower/Guarantors/ Mortgagors in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Godrej Finance Limited for the amount of **Rs. 33,19,638/- (INR Thirty Three Lakhs Nineteen Thousand Six Hundred and Thirty Eight Only)** due as on **08.06.2026** and interest thereon from **09.06.2026.**

Description Of Secured Asset/s

All That Piece and Parcel of Property Bearing House No. F-1 At First Floor On Part of Plot No. 47 Lies In Khasra No. 856 area 82.72 Sq. Mtrs at Vivekanand Puram, Mauza Sikandra Bahistabad Tehsil And Distt. Agra Pincode 282007 ("Property") Boundaries of The Said Property; **East: Opening, Stairs, Corridor And Open Duct And Thereafter House No. F-2 West: Open To Sky North: Open To Sky South: Plot No. 46 of Other**

Date: 15.08.2026
Place: Agra

Authorized Officer,
Godrej Finance Limited

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE

TENDER Notice No.: 04/TRD/DNR/OT/26-27. The Divisional Railway Manager, E.C. Railway Danapur invites sealed open tender on behalf of the President of India for the following works:
Tender No.:TRD/DNR/OT/04/25-26, 1. Name of work with its location : Supply & application of composite high voltage insulated coating/or insulating sheet under over-line structures over Danapur div. 2. Approx cost of the work (NIT value) : ₹ 5,73,56,869.14/- 3. Earnest Money to be deposited : ₹11,47,100/-, 4. Date & time for online submission and closing of all above tenders : Date & time for online submission of tender:11.09.2026 up to 12:00 hrs. 5. Website particulars, notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. : Detailed tender notice, eligibility criteria & tender documents can be seen from the CRIS website:http.//www.ireps.gov.in & full details of notice can be seen on notice board of Sr. DEE(TRD)/E.C. Railway/ Danapur. All corrigendum will be uploaded on website if required.

DivinI. Railway Manager/
ECR/Danapur
PR/0737/DNR/TRD/T/26-27/36

Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd.

Corporate Office : Unit No. 19-NE, 19th Floor, The Ruby, Senapati Bapat Marg, Near Ruparel College, Dadar (West), Mumbai, Maharashtra- 400 028

POSSESSION NOTICE **(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)**

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of **Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. (MHIL)** under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) mentioned herein below to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken Possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Muthoot Homefin (India) Ltd. for an amount as mentioned herein under with interest thereon.
The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s)/ Loan Account No./Branch	Brief details of secured assets	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1.	Kushma Devi/ Subhash Chandra/ MTH-NHL-000016/ Mathura	Description Of Property With Boundaries: Freehold Residential House Area Admeasuring 230.39 Sq. Mtrs Out Of Khasra No.448, Situated In Village Nagla Sikrawar/ Nagla Ajita, Tehsil Kirawli, District Agra, Uttar Pradesh. East: Plot Of Mr. Uday Singh, West: Gali 6ft Wide, North: 15ft Wide Sadak, South: Vacant Plot	24-Apr-26/ Rs. 11,39,487/- Rupees Eleven Lakh Thirty Nine Thousand Four Hundred Eighty Seven Only.	13-Aug-26

Date: August 15, 2026
Place: Agra

Sd/- Authorized Officer,
Muthoot Homefin (India) Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Rajesh S/o Ganesh Prasad, R/o:** H.No. F-25, F Block, Shahbad Dairy, **Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 029544/2019, U/S: 379/411/34 IPC, PS: Burari, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Rajesh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Rajesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Rajesh** of **E-FIR No. 029544/2019, U/S: 379/411/ 34 IPC, PS: Burari, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Payal Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
Central District Room No. 286
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11282/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ayub S/o Ibrahim R/o C/4, Gali No. 0, Near Sunita Medical, Babarpur, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 735/2023 U/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ayub** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ayub** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ayub** of case **FIR No. 735/2023 U/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 22, First Floor, North East District
Karkardoom Courts, Delhi

DP/11348/NE//2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kailash@Topi S/o** Vishram **R/o** Rein Basera T.T Park, Near Bangla Sahab Gurudwara, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under **FIR No. 379/2015 Dt. 20.05.2015 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC**., has been registered at **PS: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Kailash@Topi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Kailash@Topi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Kailash@Topi** of under **FIR No. 379/2015 Dt. 20.05.2015 U/s 379/356/411/34 IPC**., Registered at **P.S. Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.12.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-06 (North), Court No. 114
1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/10997/ON/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Praveen @ Vikash Swami S/o Ram Swami R/o B-65A, Gyanesh Enclave, Jain Colony, Barwala, Delhi** committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No./CC No**. 171/2019 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Shahbad Dairy, Distt. Outer North, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Praveen @ Vikash Swami** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Praveen @ Vikash Swami** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant)**.** Proclamation are hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Praveen @ Vikash Swami** of FIR No./CC No**. 171/2019 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise Act, PS Shahbad Dairy, Distt. Outer North, Delhi** are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **23.09.2026 at 10:00 AM.**

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-05 (North)
Courts No. 114, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11112/OND/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused namely **Abdul Rehman Khan, S/o. Sultan Khan, R/o.: 376, Shiv Durga Vihar, Lakkarpur, Surajkund, Faridabad, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.429/2024 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act registered at P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, South East District, New Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Abdul Rehman Khan** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Abdul Rehman Khan** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Abdul Rehman Khan,** accused of **FIR No. 429/2024 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, South East District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026.**

By Order, Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class (South East)
Room No.513, Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/11285/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN Limited

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135- 2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 676 **e-TENDER NOTICE** **Dated : 13/08/2026**

The office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :
Tender No: NIT- 31/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27
Name of work / Supply/Services: Annual/Capital Maintenance of Machine No 1,2,3,4 of Dharasu Power House for the Year 2026-27.
Estimated cost: Rs 8,76,86,692/- only + GST extra.
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 14.08.2026 from 16:00 Hrs
Last date for submission of bids on website: - 08.09.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal http://uktenders.gov.in

Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL(R.F.P.) WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT GOVERNMENT OFJHARKHAND

NIT NO. : WRD/JH/CE/DMPH/RFP/03/2026
National Competitive Bidding

1.	Name of the Work	Request for Proposal for Conducting Studies and Preparation of Detailed Investigation Reports on Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation/ Structural Health Assessment for Dam Rehabilitation/ Preparation of Emergency Action Plan, Operation and Maintenance Manual etc. of Latratu Dam under Chief Engineer, WRD, Ranchi, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Jharkhand
2.	Mode of Submission of Bids	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
3.	Tender fee (In INR)	Rs.10,000.00 (Ten thousand only) - ----(Non-refundable)
4.	Bid Security (In INR)	Rs.1,00,000/ - (One Lakh only)
5.	Time of completion	150 days from the date of LOA
6.	Date of availability of Bidding Document on Website	17/08/2026;16:00 HRS
7.	Last Date and time of submission of pre-bid queries	24/08/2026;11:00 HRS
8.	Date of Pre Bid Meeting	25/08/2026; 11:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
9.	Last Date of Submission of online Bids	07/09/2026;15:30HRS
10.	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid	08/09/2026;16:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
11.	Name of address of E-procurement officer	Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002 *Email:cedesign-wrd-jhr@nic.in*
12.	Helpline no.	9162471847, 09787107524, 09599321224, 09304037930, 09110975717

Note:-Please see details on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Chief Engineer
Design, Master Planning &Hydrology,
Water Resources Department,
Government of Jharkhand

PR.NO.387576 Water Resource(26-27):D

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

The Dy. Chief Engineer/Const Northern Railway, Shakurbasti, Delhi for and on behalf of the President of India invites e-tender under **two Packet System** for the under noted work:-

Name of work and location	Balance work for Construction of Dayabasti Grade Separator including earthwork blanketing, Retaining wall, PSC Girders, Steel GIrders, Bridges and other misc. work etc. on Dayabasti Azadpur section under Dy. CE/C/SSB
Completion period of the work	24 (twenty four Months)
Approx Cost of work	₹ 73.16 Cr
Earnest Money amount (to be deposited Online)	₹ 14633100.00
Sale/availability of tender document on Railway Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS web site i.e www.ireps.gov.in from 31.08.2026 to 14.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs
Last date/Time of upload of tenders	14.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS web site w.e.f. 31.08.2026 to 14.09.2026
Date & Time for submission of E-tender and opening of tender	14.09.2026 at 15.00 hours (immediately after closed of uploading of tender.
Opening of tender	14.09.2026 at 15.00 hours (immediately after closed of uploading of tender.

Tender Notice No. 435-ACS-C-SSB Dated: 13.08.2026 2800/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sanjay Gurang** S/o Shankar Gurang R/o H.No. 50A, Zamrudpur, GK-1, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 400/2020 U/S 323/341 IPC at P.S. Greater Kailash-I, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sanjay Gurang** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sanjay Gurang** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sanjay Gurang** accused of **FIR No. 400/2020 U/S 323/341 IPC at P.S. Greater Kailash-I, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **15.09.2026.**

By Order: Ms. Devanshi Janmeja,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04,
South-East Distt., Court No 10,
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi.

DP/11392/SD/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

ADVERTISEMENT OF TENDER

Batch No : 19/26 dated 14.08.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Principal Chief Materials Manager, East Central Railway invites e-tenders for supply of the following items :

S.N.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Quantity	Due Date	Due Time
1	03261130	F.S. All Steel Lock Nut Size-M24	31093 Nos	14.09.26	14:00
2	03263099	Pressure sensor 0-4 bar for Transformer of WAG-9 with accessories	308 Set	07.09.26	14:00
3	03263663	Set of AOH kit for ELGI Make Compressor Type-RR20100	511 Set	28.09.26	14:00
4	05253361	CVD coated 30 mm neutral insert for HYT make CNC surface wheel lathe machine	4834 Nos	07.09.26	14:00
5	03263213A	Gear case assly for WAG7 locos	285 Set	07.09.26	14:00

Note : All the above-mentioned tenders are e-tenders and all tenderers are requested to submit their bids on-line through the IREPS website at www.ireps.gov.in. All corrigendum to above-mentioned tenders shall also be published online in IREPS website only. For more details regarding the above-mentioned tenders and other supply tenders please visit IREPS website.

Principal Chief Materials Manager/
ECR/Hajipur

PR/0753/HQ/Store/T/26-27/56

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Saheed, S/o:** Md. Saluddin, **R/o:** E-117, Gali No. 4, Chand Bagh, Gokulpuri, North East Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 444/2020 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S.: Gokulpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Saheed** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Saheed** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Saheed** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 444/2020 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S.: Gokulpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Isra Zaidi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
Room No. 64, North East District
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/9660/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice No. :- SG-DSE-OT-14-26

Sl : 01. Name of work with its location : Alteration in EIs for the closure of LC gates due to upcoming ROB/LHS at different stations of GC Section in DDU Divn. **2. Approx. cost of the work :** ₹3,99,57,787.66 (Three Crore Ninety Nine Lakh Fifty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Eighty Seven and Paisa Sixty Six only). **3. Earnest Money :** ₹7,99,200.00/- (Seven Lakh Ninety Nine Thousand Two Hundred only). **Closing date & time for Submission of e-tendering :** 09/09/2026 up to 12:30 Hrs, **5. Website particulars where complete details of tender can be seen etc. : www.ireps.gov.in.**

Divnl. Signal & Telecom Engineer
East Central Railway, DDU

PR/0750/DDU/S&T/T/26-27/24

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Prem Kumar @ Kalu @ Randhir @ Nagin S/o Naginder Singh R/o H. No. 200, Metro Gali No.2, Navada, Uttam Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 336/2025 U/s 109(2)/61/190/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at PS: Hari Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Prem Kumar @ Kalu @ Randhir @ Nagin** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Prem Kumar @ Kalu @ Randhir @ Nagin** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Prem Kumar @ Kalu @ Randhir @ Nagin of FIR No. 336/2025 U/s 109(2)/61 /190/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 of PS: Hari Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 17.09.2026.**

By order
Moksha Bains-II
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
West Court -31
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11277/WD/2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, जामताड़ा

ई–पुर्ननिविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई0–पुर्ननिविदा संख्या :– 06/RII/2026-27/RWD/JAMTARA दिनांक–13.08.2026

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र0	आईडेन्टीफिकेशन संख्या/पैकेज संख्या	प्रखंड का नाम		कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि अंक में (लाख में)	प्राक्कलित राशि अक्षर में (रूपये में)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	RWD /JAMTARA/ STPKG-07/RII/2024-25	नाला	1	मधसा से बान्दो तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (1.313 कि.मी.)	1146.7762	ग्यारह करोड़ छियालीस लाख सतहत्तर हजार छः सौ बीस मात्र	15 महीना
		नाला	2	बादलपुर से कालीपाथर तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (1.843 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	3	कुरालजोरिया से केन्दुआ तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (2.001 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	4	देवजोड़ से कपासडंगाल तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (2.346 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	5	जगरनाथपुर से वृन्दाबनी तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (2.203 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	6	अफजलपुर से सरबेदिया तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (8.815 कि.मी.)			
		फतेहपुर	7	बन्दरडीहा से जामदेही तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (7.635 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	8	सागजोरिया से मंझलाडीह–2 तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (2.670 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	9	खुरियम से उदलजोरी तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (2.210 कि.मी.)			
		नाला	10	उदलजोरी से सालदेही तक पथ का सुदृढ़ीकरण कार्य (1.910 कि.मी.)			

2. बेवसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :– 24.08.2026
3. ई–निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :– 15.09.2026 अपराहन् 5:00 बजे।
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– 18.09.2026 अपराहन् 3:30 बजे।
5. निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पताः– कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा, ब्लॉक–सी, प्रथम तल्ला, कम्बाईंड बिलडिंग, जामताड़ा, पिन–815351

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये बेबसाईट jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रा0का0वि0, कार्य प्रमंडल, जामताड़ा

PR.NO.387509 District(26-27):D

BSES

BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE **Date: 15.08.2026**

Sealed tenders under two Bid System (Unpriced & Priced) is invited for following job from all bidders.

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Estimated Cost	Cost of EMD	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/ FK/CR/SS/1384	Civil Works of Water proofing for Roof top solar installations on 13 nos. Grid in BRPL.	₹ 1.11 Crore	₹ 2.22 Lakhs	28.08.2026, 15:00 HRS	28.08.2026, 15:15 HRS

Cost of each Tender Document : **₹1,180/-**

For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents etc. Please visit our website **www.bsesdelhi.com**

Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235 | Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

Office of The Executive Engineer, P.W.D Dn. No. 1, Narmadapuram. [MP]

:: Notice Inviting Tenders ::

NIT No. 31/2026/e-Tender/N.Puram **Date 07/08/2026**

Online Tender for mentioned below are being invited. The Tender have been uploaded on the e-Procurement system of Public Works Department on the Portal **https://mptenders.gov.in** Tender details are as below:-

S. No.	Tender no.	District	Nature of work	Name of work	Call No.	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. in Lacs)	Earnest Money [EMD]
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	2026_PWDRB_ 527948	N'Puram	Road work	Strengthening work of Bagra to Naya Ghodanal, Parsapani, Mahendrawadi, Churna, Kakri, Bori, Naya Sankai, Naya Kajri, Pathrai road under P.W.D. Sub Dn. Narmadapuram.	2nd	124.99	124990/-
2	2026_PWDRB_ 528883	N'Puram	Road work	B.T. Renewal of Umardha to Pasighat road, Khaparkheda to Chandon road, Sohagpur Gundrai Karanpur Amadehi Naktua Chargaon Sangai road (Karanpur to Nakgua), Sohagpur Siyarkheda to Tekapar road, Total length 15.90 Km. under PWD. Sub Dn. Pipariya.	10th	224.29	224290/-
3	2026_PWDRB_ 528884	N'Puram	Road work	Strengthening work of Raisalpur Ridhodakheda Bamhangaon road, under P.W.D. Sub Division, Narmadapuram.	4th	200.62	200620/-
				TOTAL RS.		549.90	

The document can only be purchased online from the above website after making online payment. The last date & time for purchase of document online is Dated **31/08/2026 up to 17.30 P.M.** Detailed NIT and other details can be viewed on the above mentioned portal. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not in newspaper. **The EMD & other required documents will be received through online only.**

G17141/26

Executive Engineer,
P.W.D. Dn. Narmadapuram

"स्वभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता"

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091
CIN No: L65190GJ1994PLC021012, www.icicibank.com

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Khyoda Ajin/ Risso Minika/ Khyoda Namlo Building, Papu Nallah, Near Bridge Naharlagun, Papum Pare District Papum Pare Arunachal Pradesh Naharlagun- 791110/ TBITN00007033469	Entire First Floor, Bearing No. 1 And Half 2, Block 'V', (Commonly Known As 'V-1'), Situated At Green Park (main), New Delhi -110016, Owned By Khyoda Ajin Admeasuring An Area of Entire First Floor With Two Dedicated Car Parking Space In The Stilt And Space For One Utility With Common W.C. Therein, Alongwith 22.5% Undivided, Indivisible And Impartible Ownership Rights In The Said Plot of Land Measuring 300 Sq. Yds., Plinth Area Under Sale 183.90 Sq. Mtrs. North: Road South: Half V-2 And V-3 East: Service Lane West: Road/ Date of Symbolic 12/08/2026	May 30, 2026 Rs. 4,93,54,893.95/-	Naharlagun/ New Delhi

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 15, 2026 Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer, For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "OpenTender" through on-line only (e-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No. AGCTRDT202624	**Approximate Cost:** ₹ 59,40,068/-
Name of work: Modification in OHE due to Provision of New ROB at LC 538, 540, 546, 550 & 551 in MTJ-PWL Section	
Earnest Money: ₹ 1,18,800/-	**Period of completion:** 12 months

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in**. 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** up to **15:30** Hrs on date **07.09.2026.** **1876/26(AK)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT E-Procurement Notice INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, HPPWD Kotkhai, Distt. Shimla, H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the online bids on percentage rate, in electronic tendering system, in 2 Cover System of the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors / firms registered with HPPWD Department.

Sr No.	Name of work	Estimated cost	Earnest money	Cost of Form	Time	Eligible class of contractor
1	C/o Level-III Trauma Centre Building at KotkhaiDistt. Shimla, H.P. (SH:- C/o, Civil work, W.S. S.I. and E.I. Rain Harvesting tank, septic tank i/c soak pit and site development)	106356000 (Without GST)	2127120	20000	18 Months	Class A

Tender document and other instruction scan be downloaded or viewed online from the portal **https://hptenders.gov.in** by the firm / individual registered on the website which is free of cost.

Key Dates:-

1	Date of Online Publication	20-08-2026 10:00 HRS
2	Document Download Start and End Date	20-08-2026 10:30 HRS upto 31-08-2026 0930 HRS
3	Bid Submission Start and End Date	20-08-202610:30 HRS upto 31-08-202610:00 HRS
4	Physical Submission of Tender Documents	ONLINE MODE
5	Date of Technical Bid Opening	31-08-2026 1100 HRS
6	Evaluation of Technical Bid flowed by Opening of Financial Bid.	Date to be announced

Executive Engineer,
(B&R) Division HPPWD, Kotkhai
On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

Ro No 2671/2026-2027

☞ Kind Attention Rail Passengers ☜

IMPORTANT NOTICE

Keeping in view the Independence Day Ceremony on 15.08.2026 (Saturday), trains movement between Delhi Jn. and Delhi Shahdara Jn. stations will remain temporarily suspended from 06.45 hrs to 09.00 hrs. on 15.08.26. As a result, the following trains will be temporarily Cancelled/ Diverted/ Short-terminated /Short-originated/ Regulated/Rescheduled as under:-

CANCELLATION OF TRAINS

Train No. & Train Name	Date of Cancellation (from originating station)
74021 Delhi Jn. - Saharanpur Jn. DMU	15.08.2026
64417 Ghaziabad - Delhi Jn. MEMU	15.08.2026
54058 Shamli - Delhi Jn. Passenger	15.08.2026
74024 Saharanpur Jn. - Delhi Jn. DMU	15.08.2026

DIVERSION OF TRAINS

Train No. & Train Name	Diverted Route	Date(s) (from originating station)
64402 Delhi Jn. - Sahibabad EMU	Via New Delhi - Tilak Bridge - Sahibabad	15.08.2026
64414 Delhi Jn. - Ghaziabad EMU	Via New Delhi - Tilak Bridge - Sahibabad	15.08.2026
64111 Khurja Jn. - Shakurbasti EMU	Via Sahibabad - Delhi Shahdara B Panel - Tilak Bridge - New Delhi - Delhi Kishanganj	15.08.2026
64567 Bulandshahr - Tilak Bridge MEMU	Via Sahibabad - Delhi Shahdara B Panel - Tilak Bridge	15.08.2026

SHORT TERMINATION/SHORT ORIGINATION OF TRAINS

Train No. & Train Name	Train to short terminate at / originate from	Date(s) (from originating station)
64437 Ghaziabad - Delhi Jn. EMU	at New Delhi	15.08.2026
64402 Delhi Jn. - Shahibabad EMU	from New Delhi	15.08.2026
64152 Delhi Jn. - Aligarh Jn. MEMU	from Ghaziabad and will remain cancelled between Delhi - Ghaziabad	15.08.2026
64025 Delhi Jn. - Shamli MEMU	from Delhi Shahdara and will remain cancelled between Delhi - Delhi Shahdara	15.08.2026
64022 Saharanpur-Delhi Jn. MEMU	at Delhi Shahdara	15.08.2026
64558 Haridwar - Delhi Jn. MEMU	at Delhi Shahdara	15.08.2026

REGULATION OF TRAINS

Train No. & Name	Station and Duration of Regulation
18310 Jammu Tawi - Sambalpur Jn. Express	Train will be regulated at Delhi Jn. on 15.08.2026 till security clearance.
15910 Lalgarh Jn. - Dibrugarh Avadh Assam Express	Train will be regulated at Delhi Jn. on 14.08.2026 till security clearance.
12379 Sealdah - Amritsar Jalianwala Bag Express	Train will be regulated at Delhi Shahdara on 15.08.2026 till security clearance.

RESCHEDULING OF TRAINS

Train No. & Train Name	Rescheduling of Trains (from Originating Station)
12038 Delhi Jn. - Kotdwar Siddhabali Jan Shatabdi	Train will be rescheduled to depart from Delh Jn. at 09:10 hrs. instead of 07:00 hrs. (130 minutes late) on 15.08.2026
15484 Delhi Jn. - Alipur Duar Jn. Sikkim Mahananda Exp.	Train will be rescheduled to depart from Delhi Jn. at 09:20 hrs. instead of 07:35 hrs. (105 minutes late) on 15.08.2026
12225 Azamgarh - Delhi Jn. Kaifiyat Express	Train will be rescheduled to depart from Azamgarh at 18:00 hrs. instead of 16:30 hrs. (90 minutes late) on 14.08.2026
14342 Dehradun - Shakurbasti Mussoorie Exp.	Train will be rescheduled to depart from Dehradun at 22:50 hrs. instead of 21:20 hrs. (90 minutes late) on 14.08.2026

For any kind of information such as detailed Time-Table and stations en route etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit Indian Railways website https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

Visit RailMadad website:-
www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in
Download RailMadad app.
RailMadad Helpline No.: 139
Please join us on

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Your Convenience - Our Concern
Visit us at : www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in
"SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE"

2820/2026

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	M/s. Primus Energy Solutions Private Limited/ Aditya Rao/ Anil Kumar Raao/ Lalit Ballani/ Shakuntala Rao/ 002105030631	Residential Property Bearing Flat In DLF Town House No. N-15/7, First Floor 1, Measuring Covered area of 106.73 Sq. Mtrs Along With Roof Rights Bearing Number N-15/7 Together With Impartiableand Undivided Prorata Share of Land In Plot No. 7, Road No. N-15 Measuring 251.52 Sq. Mtrs, Situated In DLF City, Phase-2 Residential Colony Known as DLF Qutub Enclave Complex In and Around Village Shahpur, Tehsil & District Gurugram, Haryana-122002., Owned By Shakuntala Rao, (Admeasuring An Area of 106.73 Sq. Mtrs North: Road South: Plot No. N-14/30 East: Road West: Plot No. N-15/6/ Date of Symbolic Possession August 12, 2026.	May 20,2026 Rs. 42,61,098.00/-	Gurgaon/ Churu

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 15, 2026
Place: Gurgaon

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

INDIA'S 'MISSION WORLD CUP' BEGINS AGAINST WALES

Sticking to the mission

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 14

It's a wait that dates back to more than half a century and the Indian men's hockey team would be determined to break the jinx this time when it begins its title quest at the FIH World Cup with a clash against Wales here on Saturday.

The Harmanpreet Singh-led side would hope to add to the country's Independence Day celebrations by beating Wales to set the tone for a campaign that could finally end one of Indian hockey's longest-standing droughts which goes back 51 years.

India's last and only World Cup triumph came in 1975, when Ajit Pal Singh's team defeated Pakistan in the final in Kuala Lumpur.

"We want to write our own piece of history in Indian hockey," coach Craig Fulton said ahead of the tournament, acknowledging the weight of the legacy while insisting that his players must create their own story rather than live in the shadow of 1975.

The country previously won bronze in 1971 and silver in 1973. More than five decades later, the current generation believes it has the experience, depth and belief to change that record.

Men's Hockey World Cup 2026 Schedule

Belgium & Netherlands — August 15-30

Pool A	Pool B	Pool C	Pool D
Argentina	Belgium	Australia	England
Japan	France	Spain	**India**
Netherlands	Germany	Ireland	Pakistan
New Zealand	Malaysia	South Africa	Wales

Date	Match number	Match
Aug 15	1	**India** *vs* Wales
	2	Germany *vs* Malaysia
	3	England *vs* Pakistan
Aug 16	4	Belgium *vs* France
	5	Australia *vs* Ireland
	6	Spain *vs* South Africa
	7	Netherlands *vs* New Zealand
	8	Argentina *vs* Japan
Aug 17	9	Pakistan *vs* Wales
	10	France *vs* Malaysia
	11	**India** *vs* England
Aug 18	12	Germany *vs* Belgium
	13	New Zealand *vs* Japan
	14	Spain *vs* Australia
	15	Ireland *vs* South Africa
	16	Argentina *vs* Netherlands
Aug 19	17	England *vs* Wales
	18	Pakistan *vs* **India**
	19	France *vs* Germany
Aug 20	20	Belgium *vs* Malaysia
	21	Australia *vs* South Africa
	22	New Zealand *vs* Argentina
	23	Ireland *vs* Spain
	24	Netherlands *vs* Japan
Aug 21	25	Pool H — 3rd Pool B *vs* 4th Pool C
	26	Pool H — 3rd Pool C *vs* 4th Pool B
	27	Pool F — 1st Pool C *vs* 2nd Pool B
Aug 22	28	Pool F — 1st Pool B *vs* 2nd Pool C
	29	Pool G — 3rd Pool A *vs* 4th Pool D
	30	Pool G — 3rd Pool D *vs* 4th Pool A
	31	Pool E — 1st Pool A *vs* 2nd Pool D
	32	Pool E — 1st Pool D *vs* 2nd Pool A
Aug 23	33	Pool H — 4th Pool B *vs* 4th Pool C
	34	Pool H — 3rd Pool B *vs* 3rd Pool C
	35	Pool F — 1st Pool B *vs* 1st Pool C
Aug 24	36	Pool F — 2nd Pool B *vs* 2nd Pool C
	37	Pool G — 4th Pool A *vs* 4th Pool D
	38	Pool G — 3rd Pool A *vs* 3rd Pool D
	39	Pool E — 2nd Pool A *vs* 2nd Pool D
	40	Pool E — 1st Pool A *vs* 1st Pool D
Aug 28	41	13/14 — 3rd Pool G *vs* 3rd Pool H
	42	15/16 — 4th Pool G *vs* 4th Pool H
	43	11/12 — 2nd Pool G *vs* 2nd Pool H
	44	9/10 — 1st Pool G *vs* 1st Pool H
	45	5/6 — 3rd Pool E *vs* 3rd Pool F
	46	7/8 — 4th Pool E *vs* 4th Pool F
	47	**Semifinal** — 1st Pool E *vs* 2nd Pool F
Aug 29	48	**Semifinal** — 1st Pool F *vs* 2nd Pool E
Aug 30	49	3/4 — Loser 47 *vs* Loser 48
	50	**Final** — **Winner 47 *vs* Winner 48**

KBK Sports Graphics

India enter the tournament with genuine optimism. The country won bronze medals at the Tokyo Olympics, ending a 41-year wait for an Olympic medal, and followed it with another bronze at the Paris Games.

The challenge now is to replicate that consistency on the World Cup stage.

"We have come here with the same passion, mindset and preparation," captain Harmanpreet had said.

"There is no pressure to win a medal in the World Cup; rather, it is our responsibility."

The opening assignment against 15th-ranked Wales appears favourable on paper for eighth-ranked India, but coach Craig Fulton's side knows that a strong start is essential.

England, ranked third in the world, and Pakistan, ranked 12th, await later in the pool, making every point valuable.

After a disappointing eighth-place finish in the nine-team Pro League last season, the team found its rhythm in the last phase of the European leg, defeating reigning world and European champions Germany and Olympic champions the Netherlands.

The Asia Cup title in Rajgir has also strengthened belief within the squad.

Fulton has opted for a blend of experience and youth after trying out 33 players during the 2025-26 Pro League season.

Veteran midfielder Manpreet Singh, India's most-capped player with 417 international appearances, provides leadership and composure, while eight players are set to experience the World Cup for the first time.

With PR Sreejesh having retired after the Paris Olympics, the responsibility in front of the goal now rests with the younger Mohit HS and Suraj Karkera. At the other end, Harmanpreet's penalty corner expertise remains one of India's biggest attacking weapons with experienced defender Amit Rohidas expected to provide stability alongside him.

The mid-field will revolve around Manpreet and Hardik Singh, while the attacking line will look towards Abhishek and Mandeep, who is only 12 matches away from 300 caps. Mental conditioning coach Paddy Upton, who was part of India's 2011 cricket World Cup-winning campaign and later worked with the hockey team at the Paris Olympics, believes the squad is equipped to handle the pressure of a long tournament.

IN SHORT

- **The Harmanpreet Singh-led side would hope to add to the country's Independence Day celebrations by beating Wales to set the tone for the campaign**
- **India's last and only World Cup triumph came in 1975, when Ajit Pal Singh's team defeated Pakistan in the final in Kuala Lumpur**

Trial by spin: Can Gill & Co pass the Sri Lanka Test?

India, Gambhir eye red-ball reset

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Galle, August 14

Shubman Gill with Sri Lanka's captain Dhananjay de Silva on the eve of the series opener PTI

A gruelling trial by spin awaits Indian batters in the two-Test series against Sri Lanka beginning here on Saturday with head coach Gautam Gambhir's standing as the country's red-ball in-charge relying heavily on its outcome.

Under Gambhir, India have been a near-infallible white-ball unit as revealed by their rampaging title-winning runs in the Champions Trophy, Asia Cup and T20 World Cup.

But Test cricket paints a grim picture. Home whitewashes against New Zealand and South Africa have put a hole in India's World Test Championship ambitions.

Those string of failures and the subsequent exit of a bunch of support staff -- two assistant coaches and a fielding coach -- have made the need for rejuvenation for Gambhir and the team immediate.

This is not to say that Gambhir will be ousted immediately even if victory eludes the team in the island nations, but the corridors of power will certainly be abuzz some talk about the way forward in the red ball format.

However, finding redemption in Galle is a tough task for visiting teams. Often, dreams die here.

If that sounds glib, then one look at the numbers would be enough.

Sri Lanka have won 27 of the 49 Tests played here since 1998, a dominance built around crafty spinners turning the knife in.

The home nation has long moved away from the heady days of Muttiah Muralitharan and Rangana Herath, but they still have spinners Prabath Jayasuriya and Ramesh Mendis, who have made Galle their fortress.

So, the situation is not to the liking of this particular Indian team, whose batters struggled massively against the likes of Mitchell Santner and Simon Harmer in the not-so-distant past.

But this team carries an eerie similarity to the squad that came to these shores in 2017, the last time India played a Test series here.

The Virat Kohli-led outfit featured a bunch of players who were in the middle phase of their careers but went back with a 3-0 triumph, including one at Galle, and it kicked off a period of India's dominance in Test cricket.

Jaglan fires 64 to claim maiden pro crown

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, August 14

Shubham Jaglan produced a superb final-round six-under 64 to clinch his maiden professional title by two shots at the second edition of the Rs 1 crore Coal India Open at Tollygunge Club on Friday.

The 21-year-old from Panipat, Haryana, carded rounds of 67, 65 and 64 to finish the weather-shortened tournament at 14-under 196. Jaglan, who is attached to the DLF Golf & Country Club in Gurugram, earned the winner's cheque of Rs 15 lakh and made a significant jump in the DP World PGTI Rankings, moving 12 places from 26th to 14th.

His victory also took his season's earnings to 26,99,875 and marked an important breakthrough for a player who has steadily built momentum on the professional circuit.

"It feels pretty awesome," Jaglan said after completing his victory. "The first win is very special. I was nervous over the last few holes, so I'm proud of the way I finished."

Jaglan had plenty of work to do when he began the final round. He was tied fifth and four shots behind overnight leader Jamal Hossain, with the tournament already having been disrupted by heavy rain.

The opening hole initially made his task tougher as he dropped a shot after a poor tee shot. However, rather than allowing the setback to affect his round, Jaglan remained composed and quickly turned his fortunes around.

"I made a poor swing with my first shot, but I didn't get upset," he said.

Tata exits, Churchill Brothers take Jamshedpur FC for Rs 100

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 14

THE GOAN CLUB IS EXPECTED TO PAY THE FULL RS 1.1 CRORE PARTICIPATION FEE TO THE ALL INDIA FOOTBALL FEDERATION BY FRIDAY'S DEADLINE

Churchill Brothers are set to feature in the upcoming Indian Super League (ISL) season starting September 4 after Tata Steel on Friday sold its entire stake in Jamshedpur Football Club to the Goan side.

The Goan club is expected to pay the full Rs 1.1 crore participation fee to the All India Football Federation (AIFF) by Friday's deadline set for all participating ISL 2026-27 clubs.

Jamshedpur FC had pulled out of the ISL and disbanded the first team on July 31, hours after the deadline for paying the first installment of participation fee amounting to Rs 55 lakh.

The AIFF had said that all the 13 other ISL clubs have paid their participation fees. On Friday, Tata Steel transferred Jamshedpur FC's Indian Super League sporting licence. The transfer of ownership for a nominal amount of Rs 100 includes the transfer of Jamshedpur FC's 12 players and two coaches to the Goan club.

Churchill will take over the contracts of all Jamshedpur FC players and coaching staff with effect from September 1. The transfer of ownership is expected to be completed by August 31.

"Tata Steel has agreed to transfer its equity shares in 'Jamshedpur Football & Sporting Private Limited' (JFSPL) to Churchill Brothers Football Club for a token consideration," Tata Steel said in a release.

Jamshedpur FC and Sporting Private Limited (JFSPL) is a wholly-owned subsidiary of Tata Steel.

In his twilight, Manpreet wants to end on a high

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Amstelveen, August 14

Gearing up for what is possibly his last campaign in a hockey World Cup, veteran Indian mid-fielder Manpreet Singh says he is determined to make it a memorable one by playing his part in taking India to the title for the first time in 51 years.

Manpreet will be playing in his fourth World Cup. He said the tournament carries added significance as India look to add to their lone triumph in 1975. "This World Cup means a lot to me because it's my fourth edition. We have won back-to-back Olympic medals, but a World Cup medal is still missing. Every player dreams of having both," Manpreet. "For me, this could be my last World Cup, so I am approaching it with that mindset. I am determined to achieve what we haven't yet."

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE NO. NER-BSB0SnT-OT-47-2026

"Open Tenders" through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm) /Varanasi/North Eastern Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works:-

Sl No.-1, Tender Notice No. and Description of Work: NER-BSB0SnT-OT-47-2026, Name of Work: Signalling work in connection with various engineering work in the jurisdiction of ADSTE/BSB & ADSTE/MAU of Varanasi division. **Details:** Approx. Value (Rs.): ₹ 2,21,50,659.26, Earnest Money (Rs.): ₹ 4,43,000/-, Cost of Tender Form (Rs.): ₹ 00.00, Completion Period: 12 Months. Tender Closing Date & Time: 09-09-2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.

(1) Tender Online will be submitted up to 15:00 hrs. on date 09-09-2026.

(2) For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. ***www.ireps.gov.in***

Divl. Rly. Manager (S&T) Varanasi

CPRO/Signal-100

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender Notice No. ST-CKP-OT-26-27-72, Dated 11.08.2026. Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Chakradharpur acting for & on behalf of The President of India invites e-Tenders against Tender No. mentioned below due to open on 01.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Name of work**: S&T work in connection with (i) Construction of 5 Lines at FBWP yard, Jharsuguda, (ii) Controlling of takeoff point of MBR siding from Karampada, (iii) One Loop Lines each in both UP & DN Grid of 70M length of Manikui. (iv) Construction of additional loading line at Rangra, (v) Construction of Additional Loading Line at Patasahi. **Tender Value:** ₹ 4,52,39,697/-, **Earnest Money:** ₹ 9,04,800/-. **Completion period:** 06 months. The tender details can be viewed at website **http://www.ireps.gov.in** The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate in e-Tendering. e-Tender forms shall be issued free of cost.

(PR-618)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mukesh Kumar @ Changa, S/o Sunhari Lal R/o H.No.23, Gali No.9, Sainik Vihar, Ph-3, Mohan Garden, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.679/16 u/s 186/332/353/34 IPC, P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mukesh Kumar @ Changa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mukesh Kumar @ Changa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mukesh Kumar @ Changa** of **FIR No.679/16 u/s 186/332/353/34 IPC, P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026.**

By Order,
Ankit Karan Singh
Metropolitan Magistrate-08 (West)
Room No.30, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/11302/OD/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE
OPEN TENDER NOTICE NO. RS-101-Window-Mod-DNR, dt: 12.08.2026

The Divisional Railway Manager, E. C. Railway, Danapur is inviting online open tender (on IREPS Portal) for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered/ working with Railway/Irrigation/CPWD/MES or any other public sector undertaking for under mentioned works:-

1. Name of work with its location : Replacement of Aluminium Window Bars and Window Support from Windows in LWS and NAC CC Coaches at ARA/DNR/RGD & RNCC Depot under Danapur division for One years. **2. Approx cost of the work :** Rs. 95,20,000/- (Rupees Ninety five Lakhs Twenty Thousand only), **3. Earnest Money to be deposited :** Rs. 1,90,400/- (Rupees One Lakh Ninety Thousand Four Hundred Only), **4. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender :** Date & Time for submission of tender 03.09.2026 up to 12:00 hrs. on **www.ireps.gov.in**, Date & Time of opening of tender 03.09.2026 at 12:30 hrs. on **www.ireps.gov.in**, **5. Website particulars & Notice Board location where complete details of tender, corrigendum (if any) can be seen etc.** : The tender notice is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Divisional Railway Manager (Mech)
East Central Railway Danapur
PR/0747//DNR/MECH/T/26-27/40

NORTHERN RAILWAY

OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE

No: NR-DL10MCNW/66/2026-O/o Sr.DME/CORD/DLI/NR **Date: 14.08.2026**

For and on behalf of President of India Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Chg.), Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites open e-tender on 'SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM' for following work from experienced and capable tenderers.

1	Name of Work	Work of Surface Defect Detection on Wheel of LHB Coaches by Eddy Current Array (ECA) technique during D-3 schedule at coaching depots of Delhi Division for period of three years.
2	Work Place	Delhi Division (ANVT, DLI, DEE, NDLS, NZM)
3	Period of Work	Three (03) Years
4	Advertised Value	Rs. 3,70,54,536.48/- (including provision of GST)
5	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 7,41,100/-, through net banking or gateway only
6	Tender Document Cost	Nil
7	Date and Time of availability of E- Tender Document	From 14.08.2026 to 07.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs
8	Date and time of E-tender Closing	07.09.2026 15:00 hrs
9	Date and time of E-tender opening	On 07.09.2026 after 15:00 hrs, if the date of opening happens to be holiday then E-Tender shall be opened on the next working day
10	Place for opening E-Tender	Mechanical Department, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-55

Note: The complete particulars of the tender may be found in website **www.ireps.gov.in**

2829/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

INVITING REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL(R.F.P.)
WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND

NIT NO. : WRD/JH/CE/DMPH/RFP/04/2026
National Competitive Bidding

1.	Name of the Work	Request for Proposal for Conducting Studies and Preparation of Detailed Investigation Reports on Comprehensive Dam Safety Evaluation/ Structural Health Assessment for Dam Rehabilitation/ Preparation of Emergency Action Plan, Operation and Maintenance Manual etc. of Ramrekha Dam under Chief Engineer, WRD, Ranchi, Water Resources Department, Govt. of Jharkhand
2.	Mode of Submission of Bids	Online through www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in
3.	Tender fee (In INR)	Rs.10,000.00 (Ten thousand only)-----(Non-refundable)
4.	Bid Security (In INR)	Rs.1,00,000/- (One Lakh only)
5.	Time of completion	150 days from the date of LOA
6.	Date of availability of Bidding Document on Website	17/08/2026;16:00 HRS
7.	Last Date and time of submission of pre-bid queries	24/08/2026;11:00 HRS
8.	Date of Pre Bid Meeting	25/08/2026; 11:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
9.	Last Date of Submission of online Bids	07/09/2026;15:30HRS
10.	Date & time of opening of Technical Bid	08/09/2026;16:30HRS Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002
11.	Name of address of E-procurement officer	Chief Engineer, Design Master Planning And Hydrology, Room No. 203, Second Floor, Jal Bhawan, Doranda, Ranchi, Jharkhand-834002 *Email:cedesign-wrd-jhr@nic.in*
12.	Helpline no.	9162471847, 09787107524, 09599321224, 09304037930, 09110975717

Note:-Please see details on www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Chief Engineer
Design, Master Planning &Hydrology,
Water Resources Department,
Government of Jharkhand

PR 387574 Water Resource(26-27).D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 84-Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita,2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Bahadur Singh R/o The DHO/DDO O/O The CDMO Central DGHS GNCT of Delhi Gali No.4, Baghichi Allaudin Nabi Karim Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 374/2023 U/s 138/142 NI Act at P.S. Sarai Rohilla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Bahadur Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Bahadur Singh** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Bahadur Singh of CC No. 374/2023 U/s 138/142 NI Act at P.S.: Sarai Rohila, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 15.09.2026.**

By order
Aradhana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-09
(NI Act) Central District,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi
DP/11407/N/2026

M.P. POWER GENERATING COMPANY LIMITED
Office Of The Addl. C.E. (P&W), Shree Singaji Thermal Power Project, Dongalia Distt. Khandwa (M.P.), E-mail ID : sepnw.sstpp1@gmail.com
No. 515-1700/SSTPP/MPPGCL/P&W/4046 **Date : 14.08.2026**

Tender Particulars/Tender Number	Estimated Cost (Rs.) (including GST)	Tender Cost & EMD in Rs.	Last Date and Time for Closing of Online Submission
Procurement of set of Carb Clad/Tribo Sol coated seat and disc (Gate) of MHV of AHP-II, 2X660 MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_521662_1)	Rs. 73,25,600/- (Including G.S.T.)	2000/- & 1,46,500/-	15.09.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs
"Annual maintenance of MPPGCL's private railway siding from Surgaon Banjari to Bir (60 Kg Rail track) and Bir Railway station to Plant (52 Kg Rail track) at SSTPP, Dongalia, Khandwa. (T-2026_MPPGC_520027_1)	Rs. 2,00,42,819/- (Including G.S.T.)	5000/- & 2,00,500/-	02.09.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs
Procurement and commissioning of Battery bank/cells along with buy back of old batteries for 2X600 MW, SSTPP, MPPGCL, Dongalia. (T-2026_MPPGC_523446_1)	Rs. 1,64,98,659/- (Including G.S.T.)	5000/- & 2,00,500/-	15.09.2026 Up to 15:30 hrs

For extension & other details, the bidders are requested to please visit e-portal of GoMP at **www.mptenders.gov.in**

M.P. Madhyam/127572/2026 **SAVE ELECTRICITY** **SE (P&W)**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Sita, W/o:** Lt. Rajender Singh **R/o:** H.No. 70 Ground and 1st Floor G-3 Block New Sainik School Gali No. 7 Sai Enclave Part-III Mohan Garden, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 997/2024, U/S: 135 Electricity Act, PS: Ranhola, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sita,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Sita,** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Sita,** of **CC No. 997/2024, U/S: 135 Electricity Act, PS: Ranhola, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Rakesh Kumar-IV
Additional Sessions Judge
Electricity Court(Central) Court No. 409
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/10783/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

DESH EK RAAG 3

Celebrating glorious 150 years of 'Vande Mataram'

It's a musical tribute to India's National Song that brings together gurus, scholars and musician tutors of ITC SRA, reaffirming ITC's commitment to preserving the country's rich heritage of Hindustani Classical music

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 14

On the occasion of India's 80th Independence Day, 'ITC Limited' celebrated 150 years of 'Vande Mataram', India's National Song, with a soulful tribute, rendered through a music video, 'Desh Ek Raag 3', created by the ITC Sangeet Research Academy (ITC SRA). The composition has been anchored in Raag 'Desh' and was brought alive by the gurus, scholars and tutors of ITC SRA alongside other musicians. The production reflects ITC's deep homage to a song that has remained one of India's most enduring symbols of national awakening, pride and unity.

In the run-up to Independence Day, ITC Chairman Sanjiv Puri shared the heartfelt creation through a post on 'LinkedIn'. He is also the Chairman of the Board of Trustees of ITCSRA.

In his 'LinkedIn' post, Puri mentioned, "On the eve of India's 80th Independence Day, it gives me immense pleasure to present 'Desh Ek Raag 3', commemorating 150 years of 'Vande Mataram', our National Song, whose timeless message of devotion, unity and love for our motherland continues to inspire generations. Especially conceived and performed for this momentous occasion by the gurus, musician tutors and 'shishyas' of the ITC Sangeet Research Academy, 'Desh Ek Raag 3' is ITC's heartfelt tribute to our great nation and its rich cultural heritage. This exclusive rendition of 'Vande Mataram' beautifully brings to life the vocal and instrumental traditions of our nation that ITC SRA has nurtured and preserved for nearly five decades."

The third edition of the 'Desh Ek Raag' series also marks ITCSRA's journey towards its Golden Jubilee in 2027. At the heart of the presentation is the Academy's timeless 'Guru-Shishya Parampara', with gurus and scholars coming together to present 'Vande Mataram' through the spirit of Hindustani classical music. Their collective performance reflects a living tradition in which musical knowledge, discipline and artistic sensibility are passed through generations of gurus and scholars.

Presented by ITC SRA as a collective homage to the nation, the musical tribute features a distinguished ensemble of gurus, including Pandit Ajoy Chakrabarty, Pandit Ulhas Kashalkar, Pandit Partha Chatterjee, Vidushi Subhra Guha, Pandit Uday Bhawalkar, Omkar Dadarkar, Abir Hossain and Brajeswar Mukherjee. Nearly 70 participants across generations have lent their voices and talent to the presentation, from 11-year-old scholar Baibhab Mukhopadhyay to the celebrated classical maestro Pandit Ajoy Chakrabarty, the first student of ITC SRA and now a guru of the academy.

The special rendition has been created by ITC SRA Guru Abir Hossain and recorded at the Academy's state-of-the-art studio. The music video has been directed by Pritha Chakraborty, an independent filmmaker and creative producer based in Kolkata.

The journey of 'Desh Ek Raag' began two years ago on India's 78th Independence Day with the first edition, conceived as an ode to the nation. The initiative returned in 2025 with 'Desh Ek Raag 2', which placed the 'Guru-Shishya Parampara' prominently at the centre of the creation and expanded the artistic canvas to include classical dance. Together, the two editions received millions of views and appreciation across platforms.

The series has since evolved into a distinctive cultural platform connecting 'Desh' and 'Raag' with ITC and ITC SRA, while reflecting the academy's sustained commitment to fostering and propagating the heritage of Hindustani classical music. 'Desh Ek Raag 3' now takes this journey forward, with a special focus on 'Vande Mataram' and the continuity of India's classical music tradition.

The participation of young Scholars alongside accomplished gurus is central to this expression. It reflects how a musical tradition can remain rooted in its heritage while continuing to find resonance among new generations.

At ITC SRA, the 'Guru-Shishya Parampara' goes beyond formal musical education. Eminent gurus provide intensive, one-to-one training, while scholars spend years learning, practising and absorbing the nuances of Hindustani classical music. The residential learning environment enables this immersive exchange, allowing musical knowledge and artistic traditions to be experienced and passed on to future generations through sustained interaction.

Established in 1977, ITC SRA has been enriched by some of India's most illustrious classical musicians over the decades, including Ustad Nissar Hussain Khan (Sahaswan Gharana), Hirabai Barodekar (Kirana Gharana), Ishtiaq Hussain Khan (Rampur Gharana), Nivruttibua Sarnaik (Atrauli-Jaipur Gharana), Girija Devi (Benaras Gharana), Latafat Hussain Khan (Agra Gharana), A. Kanan, Malabika Kanan and many others.

Today, ITC SRA trains more than 50 scholars across its Kolkata campus and Pune facility. Beyond its teaching programme, the Academy promotes Indian classical music through concerts, festivals and lecture series. Its library, archive and studio also preserve an extensive collection of books, manuscripts and recordings spanning India's rich musical history.

AT THE HEART OF THE PRESENTATION IS THE ACADEMY'S TIMELESS 'GURU-SHISHYA PARAMPARA', WITH GURUS AND SCHOLARS COMING TOGETHER TO PRESENT 'VANDE MATARAM' THROUGH THE SPIRIT OF HINDUSTANI CLASSICAL MUSIC